Elysium OSHC Policies & Procedures



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ADDITIONAL NEEDS POLICY

Including children with additional needs requires Educators to extend upon the strategies they already use in providing quality care for children. It is imperative for Educators to develop a comprehensive understanding of each child's interests and abilities and implement a program and environment that is receptive to their needs and inclusion.

PURPOSE

To be responsible for each child, irrespective of their additional needs and abilities, we aim to provide a supportive and inclusive environment that sanctions each child to fully participate in their education and care at the Service. Educators will remain encouraging, unprejudiced and supportive, ensuring that all children are treated equally and fairly and have the opportunity to grow and develop to their individual potential.

In accordance with The National Quality Standard, our Service positively responds to and welcomes children with additional needs including those who:

- Are Aboriginal or Torres Strait Islanders
- Are recent arrivals in Australia
- Have a culturally and linguistically diverse background
- Are experiencing difficult family circumstances or stress
- Are at risk of abuse or neglect
- Are experiencing language and communication difficulties
- Have a diagnosed disability—physical, sensory, intellectual, or autism spectrum disorder
- Have a medical or health condition
- Demonstrate challenging behaviours and behavioural or psychological disorders
- Have developmental delays
- Have learning difficulties
- Are gifted or have special talents
- Have other extra support needs.

We understand that additional needs may be temporary or permanent with diverse origins, which require different responses. Supporting children with additional needs enables them to participate and feel included; this also helps promote their strengths and may reduce their risk of developing mental health difficulties. Strategies for supporting children with additional needs can differ significantly, because every child is unique.

IMPLEMENTATION

Management/Nominated Supervisor will ensure

- Ensure indoor/outdoor spaces and equipment are inclusive and accessible
- Provide a program and curriculum tailored to individual needs
- Collaborate with families and external professionals, keeping plans/instructions on file
- Develop an Inclusion Support Plan (ISP) for each child and share as needed
- Seek professional training and intervention to meet children's needs
- Meet with families to share information, resources, and communication strategies
- Support educators with training, networking, and access to inclusive agencies/funding
- Maintain privacy and confidentiality at all times

Educators' will:

- Treat all children equally and fairly
- Create inclusive, adaptable programs
- Advocate for children's rights
- Communicate regularly with families (verbal, digital, meetings)
- Collaborate with professionals supporting the child
- Adapt environments to suit individual needs
- Listen to children's concerns and promote fairness and inclusion
- Model positive, respectful behaviour
- Work with families/health professionals to plan support
- Talk with children about differences and acceptance
- Encourage play and learning together to build cooperation and pro-social skills
- Consider children's sensory needs (pressure, texture, noise, colour, etc.)

EDUCATIONAL PROGRAM POLICY

Research accentuates that quality educational programs significantly influence children's development in all areas. We have the opportunity to provide a supportive learning environment and program, gaining inspiration from the children and families. Thoughtfully planned experiences and environments encourage the children to feel a sense of control over their actions, be curious and investigate, and explore their understanding of themselves, others, and the world around them.

PURPOSE

We aim to enhance children's learning and development through their experience in a positive learning environment through which the five learning outcomes from the Early Years Learning Framework (EYLF) are supported and promoted. Educators will gather and interpret information about children as individuals to inform the preparation of the environment, and implement experiences that are engaging and meaningful, supporting children's holistic development.

IMPLEMENTATION

Our Service bases its educational program on the approved learning framework My Time, Our Place: Framework for School Age Care in Australia (MTOP). The program is designed around each child's developmental needs, interests, experiences, and individuality.

The framework guides educators in planning, delivering, and evaluating quality programs that achieve the following outcomes:

- The child will have a strong sense of identity
- The child will be connected with and contribute to his or her world
- The child will have a strong sense of wellbeing
- The child will be a confident and involved learner, and
- The child will be an effective communicator.

Our Service also supports the Learning Framework through the following:

- Base learning on each child's interests and strengths.
- Collaborate with families to provide meaningful learning experiences.
- Value and celebrate each child's achievements.
- Observe, document, and reflect on children's learning and development.
- Involve children in curriculum decision-making.
- Link learning outcomes to experiences and curriculum.
- Plan programs from children's interests, spontaneous experiences, and family contributions.
- Work with external agencies where appropriate to support all children.
- Continuously evaluate and reflect on the curriculum to ensure quality learning outcomes.

Management / Nominated Supervisor / Responsible Person Will:

- Ensure a program based on MTOP is delivered to all children
- Support teamwork in preparing and implementing curriculum aligned with service philosophy
- Adapt environments for children with additional needs and arrange referrals with family consent
- Balance indoor/outdoor play with extended child-led experiences
- Promote physical activity and gross motor development
- Maintain respectful, positive communication with families
- Display the educational program for families to view

Educators Will:

- Plan, document, and evaluate learning in an ongoing cycle
- Make children's learning visible through records and displays
- Provide both structured and unstructured learning opportunities
- Respond to children's play and ideas with intentional teaching
- Promote problem-solving, reasoning, and inquiry-based learning
- Gather family input about children's needs, interests, and background
- Share program participation information with families
- Encourage learning dispositions through feedback and extension
- View children as capable decision-makers and active participants
- Support daily habits for health, hygiene, nutrition, and wellbeing
- Encourage social skills, creativity, and respect for diversity (cultural and gender)

MULTI-CULTURAL POLICY

Australia is an increasingly multi-cultural society and as we recognise more cultural and ethnic diversity, it is imperative we lead children in recognising and respecting similarities and differences in cultures. The cultural beliefs represented within the Service and wider community helps to form the foundation of the program being implemented to ensure we are promoting an inclusive environment for all children.

PURPOSE

To develop affirmative attitudes, concepts, and beliefs towards the acceptance of diversity and different cultures. Respect for diversity is a key element of quality care. Recognising, understanding and respecting cultural practices and beliefs are essential for the development of identity and self-esteem.

IMPLEMENTATION

Management/Nominated Supervisor/Responsible Person will ensure:

- Ensure all children and families are treated with fairness, respect, and inclusion
- Build and maintain links with local cultural communities
- Foster a sense of belonging for all families
- Include cultural awareness activities and celebrations in programming
- Support educators with professional learning on cultural diversity
- Guarantee equal access for all families, regardless of culture, background, or lifestyle

Educators will:

- Encourage children to respect and value differences
- Prevent exclusion based on race, gender, ability, or other differences
- Value and support each child's identity
- Promote exploration and acceptance of diversity
- Challenge bias, stereotypes, and discriminatory behaviour
- Create an inclusive environment and address comments about difference positively
- Model inclusive practices and use unbiased language
- Interact with all children in a caring, responsive, and respectful manner

TECHNOLOGY POLICY

Digital technologies and computers have become an integral part of many children's daily lives. For this reason, it is important that our Educators are not only familiar with the use of computer technologies, but are able to guide children's understanding of, and ability to use them. Technology and media items within the service will be used as an extension to the daily program assisting in the development of social, physical, emotional, cognitive, language, and creative potential of each child.

PURPOSE

Our Service will implement responsible behaviour and limit screen time when using technology to support the health and safety of each child. Educators will exercise appropriate judgement and behave in a professional and ethical manner when allowing the use of technology at the Service.

IMPLEMENTATION

The Internet is a magnificent resource for research, communication, and extending programming ideas and interests. Computer use within our Service aims to encourage children to solve problems and use logical reasoning, leading children to make decisions and choices and assisting them to use computer software competently.

Guidelines for use of technology within our Service:

- Children will be given the opportunity to use devices with some autonomy.
- Children's access to programs will be limited by the Department of Education's firewall, or through 'parent controls' on local devices. Monitoring of children's use will be noted below.
- Programs and apps will be chosen to support and promote children's cognitive investment.
- Programs are chosen that are engaging and age appropriate to children: Only 'G & PG' rated television programs and movies will be viewed at the service.
- Timeframes for 'screen time' according to Australia's Physical Activity and Sedentary Behaviour Guidelines are:
    - Children 5-12 years of age should limit screen time for entertainment to no more than 2 hours a day.
- Children will be taught responsible concepts of digital use and citizenship as children are 'growing up digital'.
- If personal devices are brought into the service, they are done so at the risk of the individual and families. We will not replace broken or damaged devices.
- Personal devices such as a mobile phone or digital watch will not be permitted to use where the device is connected to cellular data or can make phone calls.
- Staff will be restricted to company purchased and owned technology – personal devices will only be permitted in certain situations, such as when on excursion and during evacuations.
- Staff personal devices will be restricted while directly providing education and care, especially for taking images or videos of children; only company issued devices will be used for such purposes.

Management/ Nominated Supervisor/ Responsible Person will:

- Identify and support educators' technology training needs
- Ensure privacy and confidentiality are upheld
- Prevent unauthorised access to service technology and data
- Develop and share clear guidelines for technology use

Educators will:

- Follow legislation and service policies
- Keep passwords confidential and log out after use
- Access and modify only authorised files and data
- Never harass, defame, or offend others using technology
- Avoid copying, transmitting, or sharing service documents without permission
- Not use personal devices for photos or actions that breach privacy

In regards to children, Educators will:

- Support children's curiosity and safe use of technology
- Provide access to age-appropriate technologies for learning and leisure
- Use technology to extend projects and document learning
- Balance technology use with non-screen experiences
- Discuss healthy screen habits and guide responsible choices
- Model positive screen behaviours
- Encourage restful activities not reliant on technology
- Maintain a balance of active and inactive time each day
- Teach children to question and evaluate online information

ACCEPTANCE AND REFUSAL AUTHORISATION POLICY

Under the National Law and Regulations, school aged care services are required to obtain written authorisation from parents or guardians for some circumstances, to ensure that the health, safety, wellbeing, and best interests of the child are met and upheld. All authorisation and refusals are to be kept in the child's enrolment record or appropriate digital location, such as Kidsoft.

PURPOSE

We aim to ensure that all educators, staff and volunteers are consistent in how authorisations are managed and understand what does or does not constitute a correct authorisation, which consequently may lead to a refusal.

IMPLEMENTATION

Our Service will ensure we comply with the current Education and Care Services National Regulations, which require parent or guardian authorisation to be provided in matters including:

- Administration of medication to children.
- Administration of medical treatment, dental treatment, and general first aid treatment.
- Ambulance transportation.
- Excursions, including regular outings.
- Incursion attendance.
- Taking of photographs by people other than educators.
- Water based activities.
- Enrolment of children, including providing details of persons nominated to authorise consent for medical treatment or trips outside the service premises.
- Children leaving the premises in the care of someone other than a parent or guardian.

Management Will Ensure That:

- Review and maintain this policy, ensuring staff compliance
- Confirm authorised persons are listed, signed, and dated on enrolment forms before attendance
- Provide parents/guardians with service policies and excursion permission forms
- Maintain accurate attendance and visitor records
- Ensure medication is administered only with written authorisation (except emergencies such as asthma, anaphylaxis, epilepsy, diabetes)
- Allow excursions or departures only with written authorisation, or verbal permission from a guardian when approved by the Nominated Supervisor
- Enforce procedures if an inappropriate person attempts to collect a child

A Nominated Supervisor/Responsible Person Will:

- Follow service policies and procedures
- Ensure authorisation records include: child's name, date, and parent/guardian/nominated contact signature
- Keep all authorisations in the child's enrolment record or program folder
- Refuse invalid authorisations and document details, reasons, and actions taken
- Waive compliance only in emergencies requiring urgent medical treatment, contacting parents as soon as possible afterward
- Inform the Approved Provider of non-compliant authorisations

Educators Will:

- Follow service policies and procedures
- Ensure parents/guardians sign and date excursion permission forms in advance
- Allow excursions, medication, and departures only with proper authorisation (except in emergencies)
- Follow procedures if an inappropriate person attempts collection (e.g., intoxicated)
- Inform the Approved Provider if an authorisation does not meet service requirements

Families Will:

- Read and follow service policies
- Complete and sign the authorised person section of enrolment before attendance
- Update authorised person details promptly
- Advise authorised persons to bring photo ID when collecting children
- Sign and date excursion permission forms and attendance records (paper or digital)
- Provide signed, dated written authorisation for any medication to be administered

ADMINISTRATION OF FIRST AID POLICY

First aid can save lives and prevent minor injuries or illnesses from becoming major. The ability to provide prompt basic first aid is particularly important in the context of an early childhood service where Educators have a duty of care and obligation to assist children who are injured, become ill, or require support with administration of medication.

PURPOSE

Our Service has a duty of care to provide and protect the health and safety of children, families, educators, and visitors of the Service. This policy aims to support educators to:

- Preserve life
- Ensure that ill or injured persons are stabilised and comforted until medical assistance intervenes
- Monitor ill or injured persons in the recovery stage
- Apply additional first aid tactics if the condition does not improve
- Ensure the environment is safe and other people are not in danger of becoming ill or injured.

IMPLEMENTATION

First aid is the emergency aid or treatment given to persons suffering illness or injury following an accident and prior to obtaining professional medical services if required. It includes emergency treatment, maintenance of records, dressing of minor injuries, recognition and reporting of health hazards, and participation in safety programs. Legislation that governs the operation of approved children's services is based on the health, safety and welfare of children, and requires that children are protected from hazards and harm.

Management is responsible for:

- Take precautions to protect children from harm and hazards
- Ensure at least one qualified first aid educator is always present
- Appoint a nominated first aid officer
- Conduct risk assessments before excursions and plan to minimise risks
- Record and update staff first aid training details
- Induct all staff (including relief/casuals) on first aid kits, procedures, and allergies
- Notify families promptly of incidents and record details accurately
- Notify Regulatory Authorities within 24 hours of serious incidents
- Offer support and debriefing to staff after serious incidents
- Display resuscitation flow charts in indoor and outdoor areas
- Update educators on any changes to first aid procedures

A Nominated Supervisor/ Responsible Person will:

- Hold a current approved first aid qualification and stay updated on first aid procedures to inform staff
- Support staff during serious incidents or trauma
- Maintain sufficient, up-to-date first aid kits that meet Australian Standards
- Provide transportable first aid kits for excursions/activities
- Ensure educators' first aid, anaphylaxis, and asthma training remain current and ACECQA approved
- Inform families immediately if a child sustains a head injury
- Ensure accurate records for incidents, injuries, and first aid are kept
- Conduct risk assessment briefings before high-risk excursions/activities

Educators will:

- Implement correct first aid procedures when required
- Maintain current first aid, anaphylaxis, and asthma qualifications
- Practice CPR and auto-injector use annually
- Supervise children appropriately while providing first aid
- Record all incidents on the Incident, Injury, Trauma, and Illness Record
- Participate in risk assessment briefings before excursions

Parents will:

- Sign records of accidents/injuries to confirm awareness of incidents and first aid given
- Provide required information for the service's medication record
- Give written consent (via enrolment) for staff to administer first aid and call an ambulance if required
- Remain contactable directly or through listed emergency contacts

ADMINISTRATION OF MEDICATION POLICY

In supporting the health and wellbeing of children, the use of medications may be required for children at the Service. All medications must be administered as prescribed by medical practitioners and first aid guidelines to ensure the continuing health, safety, and wellbeing of the child.

PURPOSE

To ensure all educators of the Service can safely administer children's required medication with the written consent of the child's parent or guardian. Educators will follow this stringent procedure to promote the health and wellbeing of each child enrolled at the Service.

IMPLEMENTATION

Families requesting the administration of medication to their child will be required to follow the guidelines developed by the Service to ensure the safety of children and educators. The Service will follow legislative guidelines and standards to ensure the health of children, families, and educators at all times.

Management will ensure that:

- Ensure a Medication Record is completed for each child and medication type
- Accept only medication with:
    - Parent/guardian written authorisation
    - Prescription by a registered medical practitioner
    - Original packaging with pharmacy label, child's name, and valid expiry date
- Ensure medication is handed directly to an educator, not left in bags/lockers
- Notify families if medication is given in an emergency (verbal/medical authorisation)
- Notify regulatory authorities within 24 hrs of serious incidents requiring medication/ambulance
- Maintain accurate, confidential medication records and archive securely
- Inform families of medical and medication policies at enrolment
- Provide induction training on medication procedures to educators
- Request written consent on enrolment for emergency asthma, anaphylaxis, or other treatment

A Nominated Supervisor/ Responsible Person /Educators will:

- Administer medication only with proper authorisation (written/verbal/medical practitioner), except in emergencies (asthma/anaphylaxis)
- Store medications securely (refrigerated or restricted area, inaccessible to children)
- Hold current approved First Aid qualifications
- Follow safe administration steps:
    - Check Medication Form, prescription label (child's name, dosage, expiry)
    - Confirm correct child, sign/date record, return medicine to storage
    - Wash hands before/after administering medication
- Record all details on the Medication Record
- Seek clarification from families, doctors, or Public Health Unit if unsure
- Ensure doctor's instructions align with Medication Form and labels
- Report concerns to management before administering if safety is uncertain

Families will:

- Notify educators of all short-term and long-term medications (via enrolment form and verbally)
- Complete and sign a Medication Record for any medication at the service
- Provide medications in original containers with pharmacy labels and current expiry dates
- Assist with long-term medication plans signed by a medical practitioner; review at least quarterly
- Take children home when unwell and not leave medications in bags
- Hand all medication directly to an educator for safe storage
- Provide doctor's letter for non-prescription or herbal remedies (including paracetamol)

Guidelines for administration of Paracetamol

- Families supply their own paracetamol with medical practitioner instructions
- Stored securely for emergencies if parents cannot be contacted
- If a child has a temperature:
    - Notify family immediately for collection
    - Offer fluids, remove excess clothing, use cool compress, monitor symptoms
    - Keep child supervised and separated until collected

Medications kept at the service

- Check expiry dates of medications/lotions monthly
- Replace low/expired stock in first aid kits

- Notify families if a child's medication is low or expired
- Families must take home short-term medication daily
- No expired medication will be administered

Emergency Administration of Medication

- In emergencies (non-asthma/anaphylaxis), educators will attempt verbal authorisation from parent. If not reachable, educators will contact emergency contacts. If still unreachable, educators will contact a doctor or 000
- For asthma/anaphylaxis: the child's action plan will be followed. Educators will administer medications without delay, and contact:
    - Emergency services
    - Parent/guardian
    - Regulatory authority (within 24 hrs if ambulance called)
- Child will be comforted and supervised in a quiet, safe space

ANAPHYLAXIS AND ASTHMA MANAGEMENT POLICY

Anaphylaxis is a severe and sometimes sudden allergic reaction which is potentially life threatening. It can occur when a person is exposed to an allergen (such as food or an insect sting). Reactions usually begin within minutes of exposure and can progress rapidly over a period of up to two hours or more. Anaphylaxis should always be treated as a medical emergency, requiring immediate treatment. Most cases of anaphylaxis occur after a person is exposed to the allergen to which they are allergic, usually a food, insect sting or medication.

PURPOSE

Our Service is committed to providing a safe environment for all children, including those with asthma and severe allergies. We aim to minimise the risk of exposure to known allergens and ensure a prompt and effective response to asthma or anaphylaxis emergencies. Educators will support families and children through clear communication and care planning.

DUTY OF CARE

Our Service has a legal responsibility to provide

a. A safe environment for children
b. Adequate Supervision of children

Our focus is keeping children safe. Staff members including relief staff need to be aware of children at the Service who suffer from allergies that may cause an anaphylactic or asthma reaction.

BACKGROUND

- Anaphylaxis: A severe, potentially life-threatening allergic reaction, often caused by foods, insect stings, or medications. Treatment requires immediate use of an adrenaline autoinjector (e.g., EpiPen®, Anapen®).
- Asthma: A chronic condition causing airway narrowing, inflammation, and mucus build-up. Symptoms include wheezing, coughing, chest tightness, and shortness of breath. Treatment includes reliever and preventer medications.

Common allergens include peanuts, eggs, tree nuts, cow's milk, fish, shellfish, wheat, soy, sesame, and insect stings. Asthma affects approximately 1 in 10 Australians and is a leading cause of childhood hospitalisation.

Action plans:

- ASCIA Red: For individuals prescribed adrenaline autoinjectors.
- ASCIA Green: For mild/moderate allergies without prescribed autoinjectors.
- ASCIA Orange: General non-personalised posters.
- Asthma Action Plans: Developed with a medical practitioner for each child diagnosed with asthma.

IMPLEMENTATION

We will involve all educators, families and children in regular discussions about medical conditions and general health and wellbeing throughout our curriculum. The Service will adhere to privacy and confidentiality procedures when dealing with individual health needs.

A copy of all medical conditions policies will be provided to all educators, volunteers and families of the Service. It is important that communication is open between families and educators to ensure that appropriate management of anaphylactic and asthma reactions are effectively implemented.

It is imperative that all educators and volunteers at the Service follow a child's Medical Management Plan in the event of an incident related to a child's specific health care need, allergy, or medical condition.

Management, Nominated Supervisor/ Responsible Person will ensure:

- Staff training is current and documented.
- Risk minimisation plans are developed with families.
- Families provide updated action plans every 12–18 months or after medical changes.
- Food preparation staff are trained to avoid allergen cross-contamination.
- Emergency medication kits (Asthma and Anaphylaxis) are checked regularly for expiry.

Educators will:

- Follow children's Medical Management and Action Plans.
- Monitor and minimise exposure to allergens and asthma triggers.
- Ensure children only eat food provided/approved by families.
- Practice use of adrenaline autoinjectors and asthma equipment regularly.
- Increase supervision during higher-risk activities (excursions, parties, cooking).
- Record incidents and report to management, families, and regulatory authority as required.

Families will:

- Inform the Service of their child's condition on enrolment or diagnosis.
- Provide a current Action Plan signed by a medical practitioner.
- Supply prescribed medication and replace when expired.
- Communicate regularly with staff about their child's health needs.
- Support their child to understand safe practices around allergies and asthma.

In the event that a child suffers from an anaphylactic or asthma reaction, the Service and staff will:

- Follow the child's Medical Management/Action Plan.
- Administer prescribed medication (EpiPen®, reliever inhaler).
- Call 000 for an ambulance.
- Provide first aid until medical help arrives.
- Contact families and emergency contacts.
- Notify the regulatory authority within 24 hours.
- Complete an Incident Report and review risk management procedures.

ARRIVAL AND DEPARTURE POLICY

To ensure the safety of children at our Service our Arrival and Departure policy is strictly adhered to, allowing only nominated authorised persons to collect children at any time throughout the day. The daily sign in and out register is not only a legally required document to record children's attendance but also used as a record of the children on the premises should an emergency evacuation be called.

PURPOSE

We aim to ensure the protection and safety of all children, staff members, and families accessing the Service. Educators and Staff will only release children to an authorised person as named by the parent/guardian on the individual child's enrolment form.

IMPLEMENTATION

Guidelines for delivery and collection of children are put in place to ensure the safety and wellbeing of each individual child.

Before School Care:

- Children and families are greeted by an educator on arrival, with time for goodbyes to support trust and security.
- All children must be signed in by an educator after verifying the authorised person dropping them off.
- The sign-in record is used to account for children in case of emergency.
- Children must be sighted by an educator before the parent/guardian leaves.
- Any medication needs or important information must be communicated to an educator at drop-off.
- When releasing children into the school's care, educators will count and individually sign out each child.

After School Care:

- Children arrive independently and are signed in by educators once sighted.
- If a booked child does not arrive, staff will call via the school system, notify the school office, then contact guardians and, if necessary, emergency contacts.
- Parents must notify the Service if someone different is collecting their child. If not listed on the enrolment form, the person's full name and photo ID (e.g. driver's licence) must be provided and verified at pick-up.
- All children must be signed out by an educator when collected.
- Parents/authorised persons must collect children before closing time.
- No child will be withheld from an authorised contact or biological parent unless a current court order is on file. Court orders override parent requests.
- If access is denied by a court order, educators will attempt to prevent the person from taking the child without compromising safety, and will contact police and the custodial parent if necessary.
- Guardians must keep the authorised nominee list up to date. No person under 16 may collect a child.
- If a collector appears intoxicated or unfit:
    - Educators will request an alternative authorised person.
    - If the person insists, police will be contacted, and details of the situation recorded.
    - A report to Child Protection may follow.
- Educators will check all areas of the premises at closing to ensure no child remains.
- Children may only leave the Service in the event of an emergency (e.g. evacuation or medical transfer).
- All absences will be recorded.

Visitors:

To ensure we meet Work Health and Safety requirements and ensure a child safe environment, individuals visiting our Service must sign in when they arrive at the service and sign out when they leave. It is also a requirement of the National Regulations that Visitors are not left alone with children at any time.

Late Collection of Children:

- Educators will remain with children until collected.
- If guardians have not arrived by 6:00pm, staff will attempt to contact them, then authorised nominees. If no one is available, the Nominated Supervisor may contact police or relevant authorities.
- If a child is taken to a safe alternative location (e.g., police station), a notice will be displayed at the Service and Child Protection and/or the Regulatory Authority will be informed.
- Families must notify the Service if they expect to be late and, where possible, arrange an authorised person to collect their child.
- A late fee of $15 per 15 minutes will apply after closing time.
- Repeated late collection will result in a formal warning letter, and ongoing non-compliance may lead to termination of enrolment.

BUSH FIRE POLICY

Bushfires are a natural part of Australia's environment but pose serious risks to lives, property, and services. Their occurrence and severity depend on factors such as fuel load, moisture, wind, temperature, and slope.

Under Regulations 97 and 168(2) of the Education and Care Services National Regulations, services must have an emergency and evacuation policy that includes:

- a risk assessment of potential emergencies,
- clear procedures for emergency response and evacuation,
- an evacuation floor plan, and
- rehearsals at least every 3 months.

This policy outlines our bushfire response procedures, including service closures if required, and forms part of our Emergency Management Plan (EMP) to safeguard children, staff, and visitors.

PURPOSE

We aim to ensure every reasonable precaution is taken to protect children and staff from harm and hazards likely to cause injury, including potential injury from bushfires. The potential for extreme fire conditions varies greatly throughout Australia, both in frequency and severity. Our Service will adhere to the regulations outlined by our Regulatory Authority within our state or territory and be familiar with relevant legislation and other special requirements such as building regulations, traffic restrictions or emergency announcements that may apply to the area our service is located.

IMPLEMENTATION

The Service will remain informed and prepared for bushfire conditions, responding appropriately during high fire danger or local activity. The Nominated Supervisor will monitor fire ratings daily (or more frequently if needed) and communicate updates to stakeholders. Fire safety equipment will be maintained, and the Emergency Management Plan will guide staff in evacuation procedures.

DEFINITIONS

Australian fire seasons: Fire risk is highest in summer and autumn across southern Australia, influenced by the hot, dry climate.

Bushfire prone area: Land that can support or is likely to experience bushfire. Mapped by councils/state governments. Risk levels are measured by the **Bushfire Attack Level (BAL)**.

Bushfire At-Risk Register (BARR): A Victorian register of schools, kindergartens, and childcare services in high bushfire-risk areas, managed by the Department's emergency and natural disasters unit.

Fire Danger Rating (FDR): A national scale showing the severity of fire conditions, from *Low–Moderate* to *Catastrophic*. Updated daily by emergency services.

Emergency Management Plan (EMP): A documented plan identifying potential emergencies, risks, and procedures to guide staff and children's response in an emergency.

Management/Nominated Supervisors Will:

- Maintain and regularly update the Emergency Management Plan (EMP), evacuation procedures, and floor plans.
- Conduct risk assessments and confirm if the Service is in a bushfire-prone area.
- Ensure bushfire and evacuation drills are practiced every 3 months and recorded.
- Keep emergency exits clear and ensure first aid/emergency backpacks are stocked and current.
- Communicate bushfire preparation and procedures with staff, educators, and families.
- Monitor daily Fire Danger Ratings (FDR) via BOM or VIC Emergency App and act accordingly.
- Prepare for potential **Code Red Days**, including service closure if required.
- Maintain accurate daily attendance records and ensure effective communication during emergencies.
- Liaise with the school regarding hazards or faulty equipment that may impact safety.

Educators Will:

- Check service grounds daily to remove flammable/combustible materials.
- Stay informed of daily Fire Danger Ratings during bushfire season.
- Keep emergency kits organised and accessible.
- Be familiar with evacuation policies, exits, assembly areas, and roles during bushfire response.
- Remove papers, displays, and waste if fires are reported in the local district.
- Undertake training on bushfire and evacuation procedures.

CHILD PROTECTION

Our Service is committed to supporting the safety and wellbeing of all children and young people. Management, Staff and volunteers will treat all children with the utmost respect and understanding.

Our Service believes that:

- Children are capable of the same range of emotions as adults.
- Children's emotions are real and need to be accepted by adults.
- A reaction given to a child from an adult in a child's early stages of emotional development can be positive or detrimental depending on the adult's behaviour.
- Children who enhance their understanding of their body's response to a situation are more able to predict the outcome and ask for help or evade a negative situation.

PURPOSE

All Educators, Staff and Volunteers are committed to identifying possible risk and significant risk of harm to children and young people at the Service. We comprehend our duty of care responsibilities to protect children from all types of abuse and neglect and will adhere to our moral and legislative obligations at all times.

We aim to implement effective strategies to assist in ensuring the safety and wellbeing of all children. Our Service will act in the best interest of each child, assisting them to develop to their full potential in a secure and caring environment.

WHAT IS ABUSE?

Child abuse is any action or inaction that harms, or risks harming, a child's physical, emotional, or psychological wellbeing and development. It may occur as a single incident or over time.

Types of abuse include:

1. Physical abuse
2. Neglect – inadequate supervision, shelter, food, hygiene, medical or mental health care, or education
3. Sexual abuse – involving a child or young person, or exhibiting problematic sexual behaviours
4. Psychological harm
5. Danger to self or others
6. Relinquishing care
7. Carer concerns – including substance abuse, mental health issues, or domestic violence
8. Unborn child abuse

DEFINITIONS

Maltreatment: Non-accidental behaviour causing risk of physical or emotional harm, including abuse (acts of commission) and neglect (acts of omission).

Risk of Significant Harm (ROSH): Concerns about a child's safety, welfare, or wellbeing that are serious enough to require a statutory authority response.

Reasonable Grounds: An objective basis for suspecting risk of harm, based on observations, disclosures, or professional judgement.

Mandatory Reporting: The legal requirement for certain professionals, including children's service workers, to report suspected child abuse or neglect under the *Children and Young Persons (Care and Protection) Act 1998 (NSW)*.

Mandatory Reporters: Professionals in health, welfare, education, children's services, residential services, and law enforcement who must report concerns of significant harm.

IMPLEMENTATION

Our Service strongly opposes any type of abuse against a child and endorses high quality practices in relation to protecting children. Educators have an important role to support children and young people and to identify concerns that may jeopardise their safety, welfare, or wellbeing. To ensure best practice, all educators will attain Child Protection training certified by a registered training organisation. Educators will continue to maintain current knowledge of child protection and Mandatory Reporter requirements, by completing Child Protection Awareness Training annually.

Management/Nominated Supervisor will ensure:

- Ensure all persons in charge hold approved child protection training.
- Ensure all staff/volunteers:
    - Understand their roles and reporting obligations.
    - Recognise indicators of harm.

    - Report suspected harm if their supervisor has not.
- Provide ongoing training, procedures, and professional standards.
- Validate Working with Children Checks (unless exempt).
- Maintain records in line with privacy requirements.
- Notify CCYP within 7 days of any allegations, convictions, or disciplinary proceedings.
- Notify the Regulatory Authority within 7 days of suspected or alleged abuse occurring at the Service.

Educators will:

- Recognise and respond to indicators of abuse.
- Take disclosures seriously and follow reporting procedures.
- Involve children in decisions where appropriate.
- Report concerns on reasonable grounds to the Approved Provider (mandatory reporters).
- Call 000 if a child is in immediate danger.
- Refer families to support services when concerns don't meet significant harm thresholds (with consent).
- Keep detailed, factual records of concerns, disclosures, and actions.
- Do not investigate suspicions; only gather enough to report.
- Understand allegations against them are treated like any other.

Accusations Against Educators

- Allegations against staff are treated the same as any other report.
- Reports are made to CCYP where risk of significant harm is identified.
- If the Supervisor is implicated, the Approved Provider or senior educator will notify authorities.

Documenting a Concerns or Disclosures

If educators have concerns about the safety of a child, they will:

- Record observations, discussions, time, date, place, and actions taken — as soon as possible.
- Remain calm, private, and supportive when receiving disclosures.
- Do not promise secrecy; explain the need to report.
- Ask only enough to confirm the need to report.
- Use the child's own words; document word-for-word where possible.
- Do not confront the alleged perpetrator.

Confidentiality

It is important that any notification remains confidential, as it is vitally important to remember that no confirmation of any allegation can be made until the matter is investigated. The individual who makes the notification should not inform the suspected perpetrator (if known). This ensures the matter can be investigated without contamination of evidence or pre-rehearsed statements. It also minimises the risk of retaliation on the child for disclosing.

Protection for reporters

Under the *Children and Young Persons (Care and Protection) Act 1998*:

- Good faith reports do not breach professional conduct, defamation, or court proceedings.
- Reporters' identities are protected, except if required by law enforcement for serious offences.
- Reports are exempt under the Freedom of Information Act 1989.

BREACH OF CHILD PROTECTION POLICY

All educators and staff working with children have a duty of care to support and protect children. A duty of care is breached if a person:

- Does something that a reasonable person in that person's position would not do in a particular situation.
- Fails to do something that a reasonable person in that person's position would do in the circumstances.
- Acts or fails to act in a way that causes harm to someone the person owes a duty of care.

MANAGING A BREACH IN CHILD PROTECTION POLICY

Management will investigate the breaches in a fair, unbiased and supportive manner by:

- Discussing the breach with all people concerned and advising all parties of the process
- Giving the educator/staff member the opportunity to provide their version of events.
- Documenting the details of the breach, including the versions of all parties.
- Recording the outcome clearly and without bias.
- Ensuring the matters in relation to the breach are kept confidential.
- Reach a decision based on discussion and consideration of all evidence.

OUTCOME OF A BREACH IN CHILD PROTECTION POLICY

Depending on the nature of the breach outcomes may include:

- Emphasising the relevant element of the child protection policy and procedure
- Providing closer supervision
- Further education and training
- Providing mediation between those involved in the incident (where appropriate)
- Disciplinary procedures if required
- Reviewing current policies and procedures and developing new policies and procedures if necessary.

EDUCATING CHILDREN ABOUT PROTECTIVE BEHAVIOUR

Our program will educate children:

- About acceptable and unacceptable behaviour, and what is appropriate and inappropriate contact at an age appropriate level and understanding.
- About their right to feel safe at all times.
- To say 'no' to anything that makes them feel unsafe or uncomfortable.
- About how to use their own knowledge and understanding to feel safe.
- To identify feelings that they do not feel safe.
- The difference between 'good' and 'bad' secrets.
- That there is no secret or story that cannot be shared with someone they trust.
- That educators are available for them if they have any concerns.
- To tell educators of any suspicious activities or people.
- To recognise and express their feelings verbally and non-verbally.
- That they can choose to change the way they are feeling.

CHILD SAFE ENVIRONMENT POLICY

Our Out of School Hours Care (OSHC) Service is committed to the safety, wellbeing and support of all children and young people. Management, staff and volunteers take every reasonable precaution to protect children in our care and treat all children with the utmost respect and understanding at all times. We are dedicated in promoting cultural safety for Aboriginal children, cultural safety for children from culturally and/or linguistically diverse backgrounds and to providing a safe environment for children with a disability

Our OSHC Service embeds the new Child Safe Standards (VIC) [effective July 2022] and promotes a culture of safety and wellbeing to minimise the risk of child abuse or harm to children whilst promoting children's sense of security and belonging.

We acknowledge that staff within an education and care service are in a unique position to monitor behavioural and emotional changes, physical injuries, and the general wellbeing of a child due to the development of safe environments and trusting relationships with children and families. Our staff are trained to identify signs and behaviours that may indicate child abuse and thoroughly understand their obligations and responsibilities to respond to incidents, disclosures or suspicions of child abuse as mandated reporters.

Our OSHC Service takes a 'zero' tolerance approach to child abuse and are committed to raise awareness about the importance of child safety in our environment and the community.

'Keeping children safe is everyone's responsibility.'
Victoria State Government- Education and Training (2019).

PURPOSE

Our OSHC Service has a legal and ethical responsibility to provide and maintain a child safe organisation where all children are safe, respected, valued and encouraged to reach their full potential. Children's safety and wellbeing is paramount, and we aim to take all practical steps to protect children from harm, ensuring a healthy and child safe environment. Our OSHC Service provides children and staff with an environment free from the use of tobacco, alcohol and illicit drugs.

IMPLEMENTATION

Our Service upholds a strong commitment to maintaining a child-safe environment in accordance with the Education and Care Services National Regulations (Regulations 168 and 170). Management ensures all children are adequately supervised and that every reasonable precaution is taken to protect them from harm and hazards. All educators and staff implement policies and procedures that prioritise children's safety and wellbeing as part of everyday practice.

OUR COMMITMENT TO CHILD SAFETY

Our OSHC Service is committed to safety and wellbeing of all children and young people. We understand our responsibilities and statutory duty of care to comply with both the Victorian New Child Safe Standards and the Reportable Conduct Scheme to build our capacity as an organisation to prevent and respond to allegations of child abuse. We have a dedicated *Child Safety and Wellbeing Policy* which explains our service's approach to meeting the Standards.

Our OSHC Service has a zero tolerance to child abuse, and we are committed to the safety, participation and empowerment of all children. We promote diversity and tolerance and aim to form equitable and positive relationships with children. We ensure children participate in decisions affecting them and listen and respect their suggestions and ideas. We respond to any concerns, disclosures, allegations or suspicions of harm.

Our OSHC Service strongly opposes any type of abuse against a child and endorses high quality practices in relation to protecting children. All staff understand their roles and responsibilities in protecting children from abuse and neglect and maintain up-to-date knowledge of child protection law (Reg 84). Staff will undertake child protection awareness training every 12 months, and whenever significant changes are made to the child protection law or reporting requirements. Staff will comply with our Code of Conduct at all times.

RECRUITMENT

Our Service follows a consistent and rigorous recruitment and selection process to ensure only the most suitable, qualified, and child-safe individuals are employed. Recruitment includes reference checks, interviews, and assessment of the applicant's values, conduct, and understanding of child safety. All new staff complete an induction process that covers the Code of Conduct, Child Protection Policy, Child Safety and Wellbeing Policy, Reportable Conduct Scheme, and other related workplace health and safety policies to ensure a safe and supportive environment for children.

WORKING WITH CHILDREN CHECK

All staff, volunteers, students, and contractors must hold a current Working with Children Check prior to commencing employment or placement. Management is responsible for verifying each clearance, maintaining accurate records, and ensuring all Working with Children Checks remain current. Records of clearances, including the Working with Children Check number and expiry date, are reviewed periodically to ensure compliance with legal and regulatory requirements.

CHILD PROTECTION

Children and young people have the right to feel safe and be protected from harm at all times. To meet this responsibility, our Service provides ongoing training, supervision, and support to all staff to ensure they understand their role as mandatory reporters and are confident in recognising and responding to signs of abuse or neglect. Educators and staff must make a report when they believe, on reasonable grounds, that a child is at risk of significant harm.

Nominated Supervisors and Responsible Persons are required to complete an **approved child protection course annually** and to ensure all educators are equipped with the knowledge and confidence to act in the best interests of children. Through continual professional learning, we strengthen our collective capacity to identify, respond to, and report concerns quickly and appropriately.

REPORTABLE CONDUCT SCHEME

The **Reportable Conduct Scheme** enhances our organisation's ability to respond appropriately to allegations of child abuse or misconduct involving employees, contractors, students over the age of 18, or volunteers. The **Approved Provider** must notify the **Commission for Children and Young People** of any such allegations or findings of reportable conduct. Confidentiality is always maintained in line with the **Children's Guardian Act 2019**.

Our Service also meets obligations under the **Child Information Sharing Scheme (CISS)** and **Family Violence Information Sharing Scheme (FVISS)**, which allow authorised entities to exchange relevant information to promote children's safety and wellbeing. We are committed to transparency, accountability, and cooperation with all agencies to ensure that every child is protected and supported.

IMPLEMENTATION

Management/Nominated Supervisor will ensure:

- Ensure effective supervision and active risk management across all service environments
- Display emergency and evacuation floor plans near every exit and ensure drills (including lockdowns) are held at least once every 3 months
- Maintain and review safety and supervision checklists
- Keep a register of hazardous substances and relevant Safety Data Sheets (SDS)
- Ensure all equipment, furniture, and premises are safe, clean, and in good repair through regular audits and maintenance records
- Implement a risk management system to identify, assess, and control hazards (using the Risk Assessment Tool)
- Oversee emergency, evacuation, and arrival/departure procedures in line with regulations
- Ensure staff adhere to the Code of Conduct, including mandatory reporting, confidentiality, and maintaining a child-safe environment free from tobacco, drugs, and alcohol
- Maintain secure online systems, anti-virus protection, and regular backups to protect data privacy
- Ensure technology use complies with authorisations for photos, tablets, and online learning apps
- Review and improve policies regularly through consultation with children, families, and staff
- Encourage open communication with families about safety, authorisations, child protection, and inclusivity

Educators will ensure:

- Provide active and adequate supervision at all times, adapting to children's ages and activities
- Conduct daily safety checks of the physical environment and report or address hazards immediately
- Collaborate with children to create safe behaviour guidelines and discuss adventurous play
- Participate in identifying and managing risks in daily activities, excursions, and transport
- Safely store and handle hazardous substances using eco-friendly products where possible
- Ensure equipment and toys are developmentally appropriate, clean, and well maintained
- Complete risk assessments for activities with potential hazards (e.g., excursions, sun safety, food prep, water play, electrical items, behavioural risks)
- Follow emergency and evacuation procedures; support children to remain calm and safe during drills
- Only release children to authorised persons, verifying ID as required
- Comply with the Code of Conduct: act respectfully, maintain confidentiality, protect children from harm, and report concerns immediately
- Model appropriate, inclusive, and respectful behaviour toward all children
- Supervise children's use of technology and ensure only approved educational programs are used
- Encourage children to speak up about feeling unsafe and respond supportively to their concerns
- Engage families in safety discussions and keep them informed of any relevant updates

INFECTIOUS DISEASE POLICY

Our Service will minimise children's exposure to infectious diseases by adhering to all recommended guidelines from relevant authorities regarding the prevention of infectious diseases, promoting practices that reduce the transmission of infection, ensuring the exclusion of sick children and educators, supporting child immunisation, and implementing effective hygiene practices.

PURPOSE

Children encounter many other children and adults within the Service environment which can result in the contraction of infectious illnesses. Our Service has a duty of care to ensure that children, families, educators, and visitors of the Service are provided with a high level of protection during the hours of the Service's operation. We aim to manage illnesses and prevent the spread of infectious diseases throughout the Service. Immunisation is a simple, safe, and effective way of protecting people against harmful diseases before they come into contact with them in the community. Immunisation not only protects individuals, but also others within the community, by reducing the spread of disease and illnesses.

IMPLEMENTATION

New Immunisation Requirements:

- The relevant vaccinations are those under the National Immunisation Program (NIP), which covers the vaccines usually administered before age five. These vaccinations must be recorded on the Australian Immunisation Register (AIR).
- Children with medical contraindications or natural immunity for certain diseases will continue to be exempt from the requirements.
- Conscientious objection and vaccination objection on non-medical grounds will no longer be a valid exemption from immunisation requirements.

Management will ensure:

- Information on infectious disease prevention is sourced from recognised health authorities
- Health and safety policies are followed to protect children from harm
- Enrolment records include up-to-date health and immunisation information for each child
- Staff immunisation records are maintained and exclusion procedures are followed when required
- Families receive current health, hygiene, and exclusion information
- Records of illness and infectious diseases are completed and stored securely
- Health department advice is implemented and regulatory notifications are made when required
- Cleaning standards are maintained and reviewed with school authorities when relevant

A Nominated Supervisor/ Responsible person will ensure:

- A hygienic environment is maintained at all times
- Children are supported to develop healthy hygiene habits through daily routines
- Suspected infectious illnesses are responded to promptly and children's wellbeing is supported
- Families are contacted to collect unwell children as soon as practicable
- Their own immunisation status is current and shared with management
- Health and hygiene procedures are always followed, including:
    - Regular handwashing
    - Daily cleaning and disinfecting
    - Wearing gloves when handling bodily fluids
    - Safe food handling and preparation
- Weekly cleaning of all high-contact surfaces (increased during outbreaks)
- Items from toileting accidents are bagged and labelled for families
- Risk of cross-infection is reduced by thoughtful group planning and hygiene education
- Ongoing professional development in health, hygiene, and infection control is undertaken
- Only children with medical clearance (where required) return after illness

Families will:

- Provide and update their child's immunisation and medical records
- Inform the service of any diagnosed infectious illness
- Supply adequate spare clothing for toileting or illness incidents
- Collect unwell children promptly when notified

UNEXPECTED DEATH OF A CHILD AT A SERVICE POLICY

The unexpected death of a child at a Service is a traumatic event and the impact on Educators, children and families can cause emotional turmoil, which can overwhelm usual coping skills. A policy providing comprehensive procedures is therefore crucial to ensure a coordinated response and ensure the mandatory reporting requirements to the regulatory authorities are followed.

As a result of the suddenness of such an event, well-trained and experienced staff can experience strong emotions and traumatic stress responses. The role of our Service is to help restore a sense of safety for all children, Educators, and families as soon as possible following a traumatic event.

PURPOSE

Our Service will ensure that Management and Educators follow the procedures and principles within this policy and that immediate and appropriate action is taken to notify relevant authorities in the event of the death of a child whilst at the Service. There are a number of legal requirements to adhere to in the tragic event of the death of a child at a Service as outlined below.

Serious Incidents

Regulation 12 defines a serious incident involving the death of a child as:

(a) The death of a child –

I. while that child is being educated and cared for by an education and care service, or

II. following an incident occurring while that child was being educated and cared for by an education and care service;

Notification of a Serious Incident

Under the National Law and Regulations (Section 174(2) (a) and Regulation 176 (2) (a)), the approved provider must notify the regulatory authorities within 24 hours of any serious incidents. This must be done by logging into the National Quality Agenda IT System (NQA IT System).

Caring for the Wellbeing of Educators, Children and Families

Our Service will engage health professionals who may include child and family counsellors and psychologists to support our Educators during this profoundly difficult time. Health professional will assist Educators to be sensitive and mindful of the impact such an event has had on all stakeholders. With professional guidance and support, we will encourage children to express their emotions and feelings and implement strategies to assist and guide children's process of grieving and re-engage children in learning.

INITIAL ACTION AND IMPLEMENTATION OF POLICY

Management and Educators will ensure that immediate and appropriate action is taken in the event of the death of a child whilst at the Service by following and implementing the following procedures:

- Assess the situation for safety risks and provide immediate First Aid/CPR as trained.
- Call emergency services (ambulance) immediately.
- Management/Responsible Person to contact the child's parents and arrange to meet at the hospital.
- Only medical staff will inform families of the child's death.
- Notify the Regulatory Authority, Police, and Approved Provider.
- Complete all incident and injury documentation and lodge with NQA IT System.
- Contact the service's insurance company and legal representative.
- Preserve all evidence and maintain accurate records.

Management Will:

- Provide sensitive, professional support to children, families, and educators.
- Respect and accommodate cultural and family needs.
- Offer counselling and debriefing for staff and children.
- Establish clear communication protocols and ensure privacy, including social media restrictions.
- Coordinate with external agencies and investigators.
- Maintain ongoing record keeping and follow-up support for all affected parties.

Educators will support children's understanding of grief and loss by:

- Support children's emotional wellbeing with honesty, reassurance, and empathy.
- Encourage children to express feelings through talking, drawing, movement, or play.
- Provide comfort and create safe, calm spaces for reflection or time alone.
- Model respectful communication about grief and loss.
- Follow guidance from management, counsellors, and health professionals.

DIABETES MANAGEMENT POLICY

Diabetes in children can be a diagnosis that has a significant impact on families and children. It is imperative that Educators and Staff within the Service understand the responsibilities of diabetes management. Most children will require additional support from the Service and Educators to manage their diabetes whilst in attendance.

PURPOSE

Our Service is committed to providing a safe and healthy environment that is inclusive for all children, staff, visitors, and family members. The aim of this policy is to minimise the risk of a diabetic medical emergency occurring for any child whilst at our Service.

DESCRIPTION

- Type-1 Diabetes is an autoimmune condition, which occurs when the immune system damages the insulin producing cells in the pancreas. This condition is treated with insulin replacement via injections or a continuous infusion of insulin via a pump. Without insulin treatment, type-1 diabetes is life threatening.
- Type-2 Diabetes occurs when either insulin is not working effectively (insulin resistance) or the pancreas does not produce sufficient insulin (or a combination of both). Type-2 diabetes accounts for between 85 and 90 per cent of all cases of diabetes and usually develops in adults over the age of 45 years, but is increasingly occurring at a younger age. Type-2 diabetes is unlikely to be seen in children under the age of 4 years old.

DUTY OF CARE

Our Service has a legal responsibility to provide

a. A safe environment,
b. Adequate Supervision.

Staff members, including relief staff, must have adequate knowledge about diabetes to ensure the safety of children (especially in regard to hypoglycemia and safety in physical activities).

IMPLEMENTATION

Our Service promotes open communication between educators, families, and children about medical conditions and general wellbeing. We maintain privacy and confidentiality at all times.

All educators, volunteers, and families receive copies of relevant medical condition policies. Children with diabetes will only be enrolled once a completed, signed medical plan is provided by their medical practitioner and staff have received appropriate training.

All educators and volunteers must follow each child's individual Medical Management Plan in the event of a health-related incident.

Management / Nominated Supervisor will ensure that:

- Families of children with diabetes receive copies of this policy and the Medical Conditions Policy
- All staff and volunteers receive policy training during induction and review it regularly
- Staff maintain current first aid qualifications, renewed at least every 3 years
- All staff receive diabetes management and emergency response training when a diagnosed child is enrolled
- A trained staff member is always available to perform glucose or urinalysis monitoring
- Families supply all necessary monitoring equipment, medications, and emergency plans before enrolment
- Each child's Diabetes Management Plan (prepared and signed by a medical specialist) and Emergency Plan are on file, current, and displayed in key areas
- Communication plans are developed with families before enrolment and maintained throughout care
- All staff, including relief staff, know which children have diabetes, their symptoms, and the location of their plans and medications
- Appropriate snacks, meals, and drinks are always available in line with each child's management plan
- Staff on excursions carry monitoring equipment, medications, and copies of relevant plans
- Programs remain inclusive so children with diabetes can safely participate in all activities
- Diabetes Australia or relevant health authorities are consulted for up-to-date guidance and training

Educators will:

- Read and follow the Diabetes Management and Medical Conditions Policies
- Know which children are diagnosed with diabetes and the location of their plans, medications, and equipment
- Perform glucose or urinalysis monitoring as required and act according to the child's management plan
- Communicate regularly with families about the child's condition and needs
- Prevent discrimination and ensure full inclusion in all service activities
- Follow each child's Diabetes Management, Emergency Management, and Risk Minimisation Plans
- Take all necessary plans, medications, and monitoring tools on excursions or off-site activities

- Recognise and respond immediately to diabetic emergencies following the management plan
- Administer prescribed medication only as authorised under the service's Medication Policy
- Monitor and record expiry dates of prescribed medications
- Keep glucose foods and drinks accessible for treating low blood sugar (e.g. glucose tablets, jellybeans, sweetened drinks)
- Increase supervision during high-energy or special events (excursions, parties, etc.)

Families will ensure they provide the Service with:

- Provide up-to-date details of their child's health, treatment, medication, and known triggers
- Supply their doctor's contact details and emergency phone numbers
- Submit a Diabetes Management and Emergency Plan before the child starts, outlining:
    - Monitoring schedule (finger-prick or urinalysis)
    - Meal and snack requirements
    - Activity and excursion provisions
    - Symptoms and signs of hypo/hyperglycemia
    - Emergency actions and first aid steps
    - Recent photo of the child
- Provide all necessary monitoring equipment and a supply of prescribed medication as per the plan
- Inform the service immediately of any changes to their child's condition or management plan
- Communicate openly with educators about health concerns and updates

In the event that a child suffers from a diabetic emergency the Service and staff will:

- Follow the child's Diabetic Emergency Plan.
- If the child does not respond to steps within the Diabetic Emergency Plan call an ambulance immediately by dialing 000
- Continue first aid measures
- Contact the parent/guardian when practicable
- Contact the emergency contact if the parents or guardian can't be contacted when practicable
- Notify the regulatory authority within 24 hours

EMERGENCY EVACUATION POLICY

Emergency and evacuation situations in education and care services may arise for a variety of reasons, often suddenly and unexpectantly. It is vital that if an emergency situation arises, staff are confident to manage the situation effectively and efficiently, maintaining the safety and wellbeing of children, families and visitors.

Ensuring that Educators and children know what to do in an emergency situation requires vigilant planning and practice. Regularly practicing the drills for emergency situations also provides an opportunity to help support and build on children's coping mechanisms and resilience.

PURPOSE

Our Service has a duty of care to maintain the safety and wellbeing of each child, educator, and all persons using or visiting the Service during an emergency or evacuation situation. We are committed to identifying risks and potential hazards of emergency and evacuation situations by conducting thorough risk assessments on an annual basis and continually plan for further risk minimisation and improvement to our policy and procedures.

IMPLEMENTATION

We define an emergency as an unplanned, sudden or unexpected event or situation that requires immediate action to prevent harm, injury, or illness to persons, or damage to the Service's premises. Emergency situations may pose a risk to an individual's health and safety. It is important that Services identify potential emergencies that may be specific to their location and environment.

To ensure compliance with National Regulations and National Law, our Service will ensure that:

- the Approved Provider will conduct a risk assessment to identify potential emergencies that are relevant to the Service annually
- emergency evacuation plans are displayed in prominent positions near each exit at the Service premises including both the indoor and outdoor learning areas.
- the plan includes a floor plan for ease of reference with clearly defined assembly points and clearly marked exit routes from all locations within the Service
- all staff are familiar with emergency evacuation procedures and regulatory requirements
- all staff are aware of emergency evacuation points
- emergency evacuation rehearsals (drills) will be practiced and reviewed every three months by the responsible person, all staff members, volunteers, and children present on the day
- all staff are aware of their roles and responsibilities in event of an emergency situation
- each drill will be documented

All staff will maintain the following procedures:

- Keep an up-to-date register of emergency contact numbers for all children (available in hard copy and through the service software).
- Conduct both planned and spontaneous evacuation rehearsals throughout the year to test and refine emergency procedures.
- Record the time, date, and outcomes of each drill in the Emergency Evacuation Rehearsal Record.
- Document and discuss any improvements or issues identified after each rehearsal in staff meetings and include updates in the Quality Improvement Plan (QIP).
- Use a mobile phone to contact emergency services if the main phone lines are unavailable during a fire.
- Ensure all fire extinguishers, blankets, hoses, and emergency equipment are inspected and tested every six months by an authorised provider in accordance with Australian Standard AS 1851.
- Attach inspection labels or tags to each piece of equipment and file certificates of verification.
- Ensure the Nominated Supervisor makes all educators, including relief and casual staff, familiar with the Emergency Evacuation Policy and Procedures and their roles during an emergency.

EXCURSION POLICY

Excursions/incursions enhance children's learning by providing them the opportunity to participate in curriculum planned activities and experiences to extend on their skills and knowledge in the current interest topic. Our Service recognises that excursions provide opportunities for children to explore the wider community as a group and extend on the educational program provided.

PURPOSE

To ensure that all excursions and incursions undertaken by the Service are planned and conducted in a safe manner, maintaining children's wellbeing at all times in accordance with National Legislation. We believe excursions/incursions provide the children with the opportunity to expand and enhance their skills and knowledge gaining insight into their local and the wider community.

IMPLEMENTATION

Excursions will be conducted with the children's safety and wellbeing in mind at all times. We will regularly schedule incursions and visitors to our Service during school holiday periods. However, excursions during school terms may also be conducted from time to time.

Management / Nominated Supervisor will ensure that:

- Conduct and document a Risk Assessment for every excursion before seeking authorisation, in line with National Regulation 101.
- Ensure the assessment identifies and evaluates all potential risks, including the route, destination, water hazards, transport, supervision ratios, duration, and necessary safety items such as first aid kits and emergency contacts.
- Make completed risk assessments available to families upon request.
- Confirm that written parent or authorised person consent is obtained before any child leaves the service. For regular outings, one authorisation every 12 months is sufficient.
- Verify that all staff and volunteers are familiar with risk management, supervision, and emergency procedures before excursions occur.
- Ensure all vehicles used for transport are roadworthy, registered, and fitted with age-appropriate restraints in accordance with Australian Standards.
- Maintain compliance with National Child Restraint Laws, ensuring children are correctly seated and secured based on their age and size.
- Ensure buses do not exceed seating capacity, trains are boarded safely, and cars used for transport meet all safety and installation standards.
- Retain documentation of all permissions, risk assessments, and safety checks for recordkeeping and compliance purposes.

Educators will:

- Review and understand each excursion or incursion Risk Assessment and implement identified control measures.
- Supervise children closely at all times, maintaining appropriate ratios and ensuring safety when near roads, public spaces, or water.
- Ensure families have signed the Excursion Permission Form prior to the outing and that all details match the child's enrolment record.
- Carry essential safety items, including a first aid kit, medical management plans, emergency contact lists, and a mobile phone.
- Monitor and record attendance before departure, during the outing, and upon return.
- Assist children to board and exit buses or trains safely and ensure seatbelts are worn where fitted.
- Use only approved child restraints or booster seats for car travel, ensuring each is correctly fitted and fastened.
- Respond promptly to any safety concerns or incidents, following emergency procedures.
- Discuss the excursion plan and safety expectations with children to encourage awareness and responsible behaviour.

HEALTH AND SAFETY POLICY

Education and Care Services are dynamic environments that require a strong focus on health, safety, and wellbeing for all children, educators, families, and visitors. Our Service is committed to maintaining a safe, hygienic, and inclusive setting by effectively managing risks, promoting wellbeing, and complying with all relevant laws and regulations.

PURPOSE

Our aim is to protect and promote the health, safety, and welfare of everyone in our Service community by:

- Complying with the National Quality Framework, Work Health and Safety (WHS) legislation, and other relevant regulations.
- Embedding health, safety, and wellbeing principles into everyday practice.
- Continuously improving systems to ensure a secure and engaging learning environment.

Duty of Care

All staff share a legal and ethical duty of care to prevent foreseeable harm to others. This includes:

- Providing adequate supervision at all times.
- Ensuring facilities, grounds, and equipment are safe.
- Preventing bullying and unsafe conduct.
- Providing or seeking appropriate medical assistance when necessary.

The Approved Provider and Nominated Supervisor will take all reasonable steps to eliminate or minimise hazards and provide suitable training to support compliance and wellbeing.

Hazardous Materials

Our Service minimises risks associated with hazardous materials by:

- Storing chemicals securely in original, labelled containers.
- Ensuring staff are trained in safe handling and storage.
- Disposing of expired or unlabelled substances immediately.
- Protecting staff, children, and visitors from short- and long-term exposure risks.

Risky Play

The Service recognises that risk-taking is essential to children's learning and development. Educators will:

- Support safe, supervised opportunities for children to explore and challenge themselves.
- Encourage risk awareness and problem-solving within safe boundaries.
- Intervene only when necessary to prevent harm while fostering resilience and confidence.

Review and Continuous Improvement

This policy will be reviewed annually or following a significant incident to ensure compliance with current WHS laws and best practice. Feedback from staff, families, and relevant authorities will inform continuous improvement efforts.

IMPLEMENTATION

Our Service is committed to providing a safe, healthy, and inclusive environment that supports the wellbeing of children, families, and staff. We maintain compliance with the National Quality Framework and work health and safety legislation through effective policies, procedures, and practices.

Management ensures a safe workplace and environment, educators meet their health and safety obligations, and children are provided with secure, hygienic, and well-supervised care.

Educators promote healthy lifestyles through daily routines, nutrition education, and safe practices. Incidents of illness, injury, or trauma are managed in line with the Incident, Injury, Trauma and Illness Policy.

We prioritise hygiene, injury prevention, risk management, and active supervision to ensure quality education and care in a safe and supportive setting.

Management / Nominated Supervisor will ensure that:

- Maintain compliance with WHS legislation, the National Regulations, and Service policies.
- Ensure facilities, equipment, and materials meet safety and developmental standards.
- Maintain an up-to-date register of hazardous chemicals with current Safety Data Sheets (SDS) and safe storage practices.
- Provide and enforce the use of personal protective equipment (PPE) where required.
- Investigate and document all workplace incidents and accidents, ensuring corrective action is taken.
- Liaise with authorities to maintain compliance with fire safety, ventilation, lighting, and building standards.
- Conduct regular safety audits, risk assessments, and emergency drills.
- Consult with staff about WHS matters and ensure participation in safety-related decision-making.

- Support staff through wellbeing initiatives and safe return-to-work programs.
- Ensure all cleaning schedules and contracts meet hygiene standards.
- Provide immediate medical support or contact emergency services if exposure or injury occurs.

Educators will:

- Follow all Service WHS and health procedures.
- Conduct daily safety checks of indoor and outdoor environments, equipment, and play spaces.
- Record hazards, damage, or unsafe conditions in the maintenance register and report them promptly.
- Maintain high hygiene standards, including cleaning, handwashing, and spill management.
- Use cleaning products safely and according to manufacturer's instructions.
- Supervise children at all times and ensure age-appropriate use of equipment.
- Promote health and safety awareness among children through modelling and discussion.
- Store chemicals, tools, and hot beverages safely and out of children's reach.
- Participate in WHS training and report hazards or incidents immediately.
- Maintain accurate documentation for incidents, injuries, or hazards.

Families and Visitors will:

- Take reasonable care for their own health and safety.
- Follow Service policies and procedures.
- Report any hazards or safety concerns to staff immediately.

SunSmart

Our Service will work within the framework of the SunSmart Program to ensure children's health and safety is maintained at all times whilst at the Service to reduce UV damage to those in care, including Educators.

Management / Nominated Supervisor will ensure that:

- Implement and review the **SunSmart Program** to ensure effective UV protection measures are consistently applied.
- Monitor daily **UV index levels** and ensure outdoor activities are planned according to risk periods:
    - **October–March:** Sun protection required at all times, with outdoor play minimised between **11am–3pm**.
    - **April–September:** Outdoor play can occur at any time with standard protection when the **UV index is below 3**.
- Provide shaded areas and ensure all outdoor environments support safe play with access to shade, water, and rest areas.
- Ensure **SPF50+ broad-spectrum, water-resistant sunscreen** is available, stored correctly, and checked regularly for expiry.
- Communicate policy requirements clearly to educators, families, and visitors, and display the SunSmart policy for ongoing reference.
- Incorporate sun safety into **excursion planning** and ensure risk assessments include UV protection strategies.
- Provide educational materials and updates through newsletters, signage, and family communications.

Educators will:

- Model **sun safe behaviours** at all times by wearing appropriate hats, applying sunscreen, seeking shade, and using protective clothing.
- Ensure all children wear **sun safe hats** that protect the face, neck, and ears (legionnaire, bucket, or broad-brimmed styles).
    - Children without a hat must play in shaded or indoor areas or be offered a spare Service hat.
- Apply and reapply **SPF50+ sunscreen** 20 minutes before outdoor play and every **2 hours** thereafter when the UV index is **3 or above**.
- Encourage and assist children to apply sunscreen independently where age-appropriate, fostering self-care skills.
- Promote shade use and ensure play areas are adjusted based on UV conditions.
- Encourage families to support sun safety by providing appropriate hats and clothing and modelling sun-safe habits.
- Integrate **sun protection education** into daily programs, helping children understand why and how to protect themselves from the sun.
- Store sunscreen in a cool, shaded place and ensure all products are within their use-by date.

Manual Handling

Our service aims to protect workers from injury by identifying and mitigating the risks of hazardous tasks, such as lifting, pushing, or pulling, which can involve high force, repetitive movements, or awkward postures.

Management / Nominated Supervisor will ensure that:

- Ensure all staff receive induction and ongoing training in safe **manual handling** techniques.
- Provide appropriate and well-maintained **equipment** and **furniture** to minimise physical strain and reduce the need for excessive bending, twisting, or lifting.
- Maintain a safe environment that supports correct body mechanics and ergonomic practices.
- Conduct regular **risk assessments** of manual handling tasks and implement measures to reduce risk and fatigue.
- Encourage warm-up stretches at the start of each shift, especially during colder months, to help prevent muscle strain.
- Promote a workplace culture that prioritises teamwork and communication when performing physical tasks.

Educators will:

- Use correct manual handling techniques when lifting, carrying, pushing, or pulling objects or when assisting children.
- Bend at the knees, not the waist, and keep loads close to the body's centre of gravity.
- Move their feet rather than twisting the spine when changing direction.
- Kneel or sit instead of bending down for extended periods and avoid overreaching or lifting above shoulder height.
- Use ladders, trolleys, or step stools when needed to minimise strain and ensure safety.
- Request assistance for heavy or awkward items and coordinate movements during **team lifts**, with one person leading the timing and direction.
- Keep equipment and work areas tidy and free of obstacles to reduce trip and strain hazards.
- Choose seating and table heights that support ergonomic posture when performing administrative or planning tasks.
- Report faulty or unsafe equipment immediately to management.
- Incorporate simple warm-up stretches before physical work and after breaks to reduce injury risk.

INCIDENT, ILLNESS, INJURY & TRAUMA POLICY

In education and care services, illness and disease can spread easily from one child to another, even when implementing the recommended hygiene and infection control practices. When groups of children play together and are in new surroundings accidents and illnesses may occur. Our Service is committed to reducing illness and the likelihood of accidents through its risk management and effective hygiene practices.

PURPOSE

Educators have a duty of care to respond to and manage illnesses, accidents, incidents, and trauma that may occur at the Service to ensure the safety and wellbeing of children, educators and visitors. This policy will guide educators to manage illness and prevent injury and the spread of infectious diseases.

IMPLEMENTATION

Identifying Signs and Symptoms of Illness

Educators and Management are not doctors and are unable to diagnose an illness or infectious disease. To ensure the symptoms are not infectious and to minimise the spread of an infection, medical advice is required to ensure a safe and healthy environment.

Management / Nominated Supervisor will ensure that:

- Ensure all educators follow service policies and procedures for illness, injury, and trauma management.
- Notify parents or guardians within 24 hours of any illness, injury, or trauma, and advise when the child can safely return to care.
- Notify the Regulatory Authority within 24 hours of any serious incident or where emergency services are called.
- Maintain current first aid, asthma, and anaphylaxis training for all required staff and ensure first aid kits are fully stocked, checked regularly, and accessible at all times (including excursions).
- Oversee exclusion procedures to prevent infection spread, ensuring children or staff remain home for at least 24–48 hours after symptoms cease.
- Ensure all incidents, illnesses, and trauma events are documented accurately in the Illness and Incident Register and relevant forms are completed promptly.
- Communicate with families about any infectious diseases detected at the Service within 24 hours of confirmation.
- Ensure all staff and children follow hand hygiene, safe food handling, and cleaning practices to reduce infection transmission.
- Support educators and families by providing resources or referrals when dealing with children affected by trauma or illness.

Educators will:

- Monitor children's health and wellbeing, recognising early signs of illness such as fever, vomiting, diarrhoea, rashes, coughing, or behavioural changes.
- Record symptoms and observations in the Illness Register and notify parents immediately of any significant health concern.
- Exclude children showing signs of fever (38°C or above) until they are symptom-free for 24 hours, and exclude those with vomiting or diarrhoea for 48 hours after symptoms cease.
- Manage minor illnesses by encouraging rest, removing excess clothing, and offering fluids; never use cold water for cooling and always respect cultural practices.
- Administer medication such as Paracetamol or Nurofen only with written or verbal parental authorisation, documenting time, dosage, and staff signature.
- Follow infection control practices, cleaning and sanitising affected areas promptly and using protective equipment when handling body fluids.
- Ensure children who are unwell are cared for comfortably in a supervised quiet area while waiting for collection.
- Respond immediately to any injury or trauma, administering first aid and providing emotional reassurance to the child.
- Complete an Incident, Injury, Trauma and Illness Record as soon as possible after an event, attaching any relevant evidence.
- Support children affected by trauma through patient, sensitive care, offering relaxation areas, quiet play, and emotional reassurance.
- Observe and document behavioural changes that may indicate emotional distress and share this information sensitively with families.
- Practice self-care and seek support from management or professional networks when assisting children affected by trauma or distress.

LOCKDOWN POLICY

Our Service is committed to the ongoing safety and wellbeing of children, staff, families and visitors. To achieve this, we will implement a clear plan to manage all emergency situations, including a plan for emergencies that may require our Service to go into lockdown and ensure our educators and staff are well equipped with the knowledge and expertise to respond effectively when required.

PURPOSE

We aim to minimise the risk of harm, ensuring the safety of children, Educators, families, and visitors of the Service in the event of a threatening situation.

IMPLEMENTATION

Our Service maintains clear emergency procedures for both **evacuation** and **lockdown** events to ensure the safety and wellbeing of all children, educators, families, and visitors. These procedures comply with all regulatory requirements and follow recognised safety authority recommendations.

Lockdowns are implemented when it is **safer to remain indoors** than to evacuate. There are three levels of lockdown depending on the nature of the threat:

1 1. External Threat

Used when a potential danger exists **outside** the premises (e.g. unidentified animal, insects, or suspicious activity). All doors and windows are secured to prevent entry, but usual indoor activities may continue calmly.

2 2. Shelter-in-Place

Used during **environmental or health hazards** such as severe storms, heavy smoke, gas leaks, or chemical spills. Windows and vents are closed, air conditioning turned off if required, and children remain indoors engaging in quiet play until it is safe to resume normal activity.

3 3. Full Lockdown

Used when there is a **direct or serious threat** to safety, such as an intruder, intoxicated person, or civil disturbance. Children and staff move to a secure room not visible from outside, lock internal and external doors, close blinds, and remain silent until advised it is safe by emergency services.

Management or nominated supervisor will:

- Develop and review an annual **risk assessment** identifying potential emergencies requiring lockdown.
- Consult with relevant **authorities and stakeholders** to strengthen risk management and emergency preparedness.
- Nominate the **person(s) authorised** to manage lockdown procedures.
- Establish and maintain clear **communication channels** for all types of lockdowns.
- Determine and communicate the **alert signals** for each lockdown type (external threat, shelter-in-place, full lockdown).
- Design a **movement and wellbeing plan** for children and staff when outdoors or away from indoor learning areas.
- Develop procedures for **checking attendance** and maintaining communication with educators, families, and visitors during a lockdown.
- Document and communicate all **staff and educator responsibilities** during lockdown situations.
- Ensure all individuals on site remain safely indoors until the all-clear is given.
- Schedule **lockdown drills every three months**, at varying times, so all staff and children can participate.
- Review and document each lockdown drill, reflecting on improvements in practice and procedure.
- Communicate lockdown procedures and drill outcomes to **families** to promote transparency and reassurance.

Educators will:

- Follow all lockdown procedures as outlined in **induction training** and ongoing **professional development**.
- Respond calmly and promptly to the **lockdown signal**, moving children to the designated safe area.
- Secure all doors and windows, close blinds, and ensure children remain quiet and out of sight where required.
- Conduct a **headcount or roll check** immediately and report attendance to the Nominated Supervisor.
- Comfort and reassure children, maintaining a calm environment throughout the lockdown.
- Ensure communication devices (e.g. phones, walkie-talkies) remain accessible for updates.
- Remain in lockdown until the **all-clear signal** is given by the Nominated Supervisor or emergency services.
- Participate in and provide feedback after lockdown drills to support continuous improvement.

MEDICAL CONDITIONS POLICY

To support children's wellbeing and manage individual health requirements, our Service will work in accordance with the Education and Care Services National Regulations to ensure health related policies and procedures are implemented.

PURPOSE

We aim to efficiently respond to and manage medical conditions at the Service ensuring the safety and wellbeing of all children, staff, families, and visitors.

IMPLEMENTATION

Our Service is committed to adhering to privacy and confidentiality procedures when dealing with individual health and medical requirements. There are a number of concerns that must be considered when a child with a diagnosed health care need, allergy, or medical condition is enrolled at the service. Key procedures and strategies must be in place prior to the child commencing at the Service to ensure their individual health and safety.

The Approved Provider / Management will ensure:

- Ensure educators have a thorough understanding of each child's individual medical condition and their specific care needs.
- Maintain ongoing, open communication with families and relevant medical professionals.
- Provide educators with training to confidently manage specific medical conditions and respond to emergencies.
- Ensure an educator with current first aid, CPR, emergency asthma, and emergency anaphylaxis certification is present at all times.
- Confirm that all required medical information — including a Medical Management Plan, Risk Minimisation Plan, Communication Plan, and prescribed medications — is provided and current before a child's enrolment.
- Ensure all plans are reviewed at least every six months or earlier if there are changes to a child's condition.
- Display each child's Medical Management Plan discreetly in staff-only areas accessible to educators.
- Inform casual and relief staff of children with diagnosed medical conditions, their triggers, and emergency procedures.
- Respond promptly to medical incidents by following the child's Emergency Medical Action Plan, calling 000, administering first aid, and notifying families and the regulatory authority within 24 hours if required.
- Review and update the service's medical conditions procedures annually and after any incident.

Educators will:

- Familiarise themselves with each child's Medical Management Plan, Risk Minimisation Plan, and Communication Plan.
- Follow the procedures outlined in these plans and the service's medical conditions policy at all times.
- Ensure all prescribed medication is accessible, clearly labelled, within expiry, and stored safely according to policy.
- Support children's wellbeing through inclusive practices and by being alert to signs of allergic reaction, asthma attack, or other medical emergencies.
- Maintain hygiene practices and minimise exposure to allergens and other known triggers.
- Communicate daily with families about any health concerns or incidents relating to their child.
- Immediately respond to a reaction, incident, or medical emergency by:
    - Following the child's Emergency Medical Action Plan.
    - Administering first aid and calling 000 if required.
    - Notifying management and the child's family as soon as practicable.
- Participate in regular training, drills, and updates relating to health, safety, and medical conditions management.

Families will ensure:

- Provide accurate and complete information regarding their child's medical condition, medication requirements, and emergency contacts.
- Supply an up-to-date Medical Management Plan prepared and signed by a registered medical practitioner before enrolment.
- Review and update the Medical Management Plan, Risk Minimisation Plan, and prescribed medication at least every six months, or whenever changes occur.
- Provide all required medication clearly labelled, in-date, and as prescribed.
- Notify the service immediately of any changes to their child's condition, treatment, or medical needs.
- Work collaboratively with educators and management to develop, review, and update the Risk Minimisation and Communication Plans.
- Support staff by ensuring children do not attend the service without their prescribed medication and required documentation.

NUTRITION & FOOD SAFETY POLICY

Our Service recognises the importance of safe food handling and healthy eating to promote the growth and development of young children and is committed to supporting the healthy food and drink choices of children in our care. We are committed to implementing the healthy eating key messages outlined in the Australian Dietary Guidelines and the Australian Guide to Healthy Eating.

PURPOSE

Our Service follows the Australian Dietary Guidelines to ensure children receive nutritious food and drinks that support their growth and wellbeing.

We work in partnership with families to promote healthy eating habits and nutrition education, recognising that positive habits formed in childhood support lifelong health and reduce risks of conditions such as obesity, diabetes, and heart disease.

We are committed to providing a positive eating environment that respects children's dietary needs, cultural and family values, and encourages learning about healthy lifestyles.

IMPLEMENTATION

Our Service has a responsibility to help children to develop good food practices and approaches, by working with families and educators, and promoting healthy food and drinks based on the Australian Guide to Healthy Eating and the Dietary Guidelines for Children and Adolescents.

The Approved Provider / Management will ensure:

- Ensure all food provided by the service aligns with the Australian Dietary Guidelines and the Eat for Health recommendations.
- Approve and display a nutritionally balanced menu that includes a variety of fruits, vegetables, whole grains, dairy, lean meats, and vegetarian options.
- Review and rotate menus regularly to maintain children's interest and meet dietary needs.
- Ensure water is always available to children and that healthy drinks (preferably water or milk) are offered.
- Identify and document any children with allergies, intolerances, or medical dietary needs, ensuring individual management plans are in place.
- Ensure staff receive food safety and hygiene training and that all facilities meet Food Standards Australia and New Zealand requirements.
- Oversee regular cleaning, maintenance, and temperature checks for food storage areas, refrigerators, and freezers.
- Display menus and nutritional information in accessible areas for families.
- Implement and monitor food safety procedures for purchasing, transporting, storing, preparing, and serving food.
- Ensure cooking with children is supervised and conducted according to safe food-handling practices.

Educators will:

- Follow the service's food safety, hygiene, and allergy management procedures at all times.
- Supervise children closely during meals and snacks and ensure they are seated while eating or drinking.
- Encourage positive and relaxed mealtimes where children can eat at their own pace and make healthy choices.
- Never use food as a punishment or reward, nor force children to eat.
- Promote good hygiene by washing hands before and after handling food or eating.
- Present food attractively and encourage children to try new foods without pressure.
- Discuss healthy eating and safe food handling during activities and throughout the daily program.
- Store and handle food according to hygiene procedures — keeping hot food above 60°C, cold food below 5°C, and preventing cross-contamination.
- Label and store food appropriately, following the FIFO (First In, First Out) system.
- Exclude any unwell staff from food handling duties.
- Engage children in hands-on cooking and food preparation experiences safely, reinforcing hygiene and nutrition concepts.

Families will ensure:

- Inform the service of their child's dietary needs, allergies, and cultural or religious food preferences.
- Work collaboratively with educators to support consistent healthy eating messages between home and the service.
- Provide food and drink items that align with the service's healthy eating policy (if supplying meals or snacks).
- Update the service if their child's dietary or medical requirements change.
- Encourage healthy eating habits at home to complement the service's nutrition education.

PHOTOGRAPH POLICY

Children have the right to be protected from the misuse of photographic and video images whilst at the Service. To ensure the privacy of children and families is respected, our Service will only use photographs of children to support their learning and to record individual developmental progress.

PURPOSE

We aim to ensure that the privacy of children and families are respected and maintained at times when Educators, staff and students take photographs.

IMPLEMENTATION

The displaying of photos provides children and families with a sense of belonging. Photographs allow children to see themselves at play, are a topic of conversation for children and parents, allow families to see their child at play, and convey the message to children that what they are doing is important. However, it is fundamental to respect the rights of all children and families to privacy.

The Approved Provider / Management will ensure:

- Ensure all photography and video recording practices comply with privacy, child protection, and confidentiality requirements.
- Obtain written consent from families during enrolment regarding the use of their child's image in photographs or videos.
- Respect and uphold a family's right to decline consent for their child to be photographed or recorded.
- Communicate clearly how images will be used — including for documentation, programming, display, or portfolios — and ensure parents are informed of their rights to withdraw consent at any time.
- Ensure only authorised staff, students, or contractors (with written parental approval) are permitted to take photographs or videos.
- Prohibit the use of personal cameras, mobile phones, or other private recording devices by staff, visitors, or families for capturing children's images.
- Store all photographs and videos securely on service-approved devices or software systems that protect against unauthorised access, sharing, or download.
- Monitor and review all practices related to image collection and storage annually to ensure continued compliance with privacy and safety standards.
- Immediately address any breaches of the photography and privacy policy in line with the service's Code of Conduct and child safety procedures.

Educators will:

- Take photographs and videos only for educational and documentation purposes, such as tracking children's learning and development or recording activities and projects.
- Use only service-approved cameras or digital devices to capture and store images.
- Ensure children are appropriately dressed and engaged in suitable activities before taking photographs or videos.
- Respect each family's consent preferences and ensure that children whose families have opted out are not photographed or included in group images.
- Support children in taking photos as part of learning experiences but ensure images remain within the service and are not shared externally.
- Never use personal mobile phones or personal cameras to photograph or record children under any circumstance.
- Ensure that any videos or photos taken are used respectfully and deleted when no longer required or upon a family's request.
- Supervise visitors and students at all times to ensure they comply with the service's photography and privacy requirements.

SLEEPING AND REST REQUIREMENTS POLICY

There are many factors that contribute to a child's need for sleep and rest. Although unusual for a child to require sleep in OSHC settings, educators will provide for the need if it arises. Educators support an environment where children may choose leisure and play activities that allow for relaxation, wellness and reflection time. Our objective is to meet these needs by providing a comfortable, relaxing and safe space to enable children the time and space they need to feel comfortable and recharge. This environment will also be well supervised ensuring all children feel secure.

PURPOSE

Our Service will ensure that all children have appropriate opportunities to sleep, rest and relax in accordance with their individual needs. Our Service will need to determine if there are exceptional circumstances that relate to a child's need for sleep during OSHC times and make appropriate steps to alter programming and supervision if needed. We have a duty of care to ensure children are provided with a high level of safety when sleeping and resting and every reasonable precaution is taken to protect them from harm and hazard.

IMPLEMENTATION

As per Standard 2.1 (Element 2.1.1) of the National Quality Standard, each child's comfort must be provided for and there must be appropriate opportunities to meet each child's sleep, rest and relaxation needs.

Our Service defines 'rest' as a period of inactivity, solitude, calmness, or tranquillity, and can include a child being in a state of sleep.

Management will ensure:

- Provide safe, hazard-free sleep and rest environments with adequate ventilation, temperature control, and natural lighting.
- Ensure all sleep and rest areas are regularly checked, maintained, and meet Australian safety standards.
- Ensure supervision practices meet National Regulations — children must always be visible and within hearing range while resting or sleeping.
- Require that periods of sleep and rest are documented and communicated to families daily.
- Support educators in understanding safe sleep practices through regular training and professional development.
- Assess and review cases where a child's regular sleep during OSHC hours may warrant child protection follow-up, notifying relevant authorities when required.

Responsible Person / Educators will:

- Respond sensitively and promptly to each child's individual need for sleep or rest, considering their age, development, and family routines.
- Supervise all children who are sleeping or resting by keeping them within sight and hearing distance at all times.
- Conduct regular visual checks on sleeping children, monitoring breathing, colour, and comfort.
- Ensure each child's face remains uncovered during rest and that bedding is arranged safely to prevent suffocation or overheating.
- Maintain a calm, safe, and respectful rest environment free from hazards.
- Document all rest and sleep times accurately and report any irregularities or concerns to the Nominated Supervisor.
- Prioritise children's safety and wellbeing at all times when managing rest and sleep routines.

REPORTABLE CONDUCT SCHEME POLICY

Our Service is committed to the safety, wellbeing, and support of all children in our care. From January 1st, 2019, the Reportable Conduct Scheme has been implemented in Victoria. This aims to complement the Child Safe Standards and other existing child safety measures and ensure that timely reports are made and investigated should there be allegations against employees, volunteers, or visitors of the Service (State of Victoria [Commission for Children and Young People], 2018).

PURPOSE

Management, educators and staff are committed to identifying possible risk and significant risk of harm to children and young people at the Service. We understand our duty of care to protect children from all types of abuse, including protecting them from potential abuse that could occur within the service by employees, visitors, students or contractors. It is therefore imperative that all staff have a thorough knowledge and understanding of the requirements of the Reportable Conduct Scheme, which seeks to improve the responses of organisations to allegations of child abuse and neglect by their employees or volunteers.

DEFINITIONS

Reportable Conduct Includes:

- Sexual offences or misconduct against, with, or in the presence of a child.
- Physical violence against, with, or in the presence of a child.
- Behaviour causing significant emotional or psychological harm.
- Significant neglect of a child.

Head of the Organisation

At *Elysium OSHC*, the Approved Provider is the Head of the Organisation.

Failure to Disclose

Under the *Crimes Act 1958 (Vic)*, all adults must report to Victoria Police if they reasonably believe an adult has committed a sexual offence against a child under 16.

Failure to Protect

Under the *Crimes Act 1958 (Vic)*, those in positions of authority must act to remove or reduce the risk of sexual abuse to a child under their care.

Mandatory Reporters

Professionals such as early childhood educators, under the *Children, Youth and Families Act 2005 (s.182)*, must report to Child Protection if they reasonably believe a child is in need of protection.

Reasonable Grounds

A belief based on what a reasonable person would conclude, including when:

- A child discloses abuse (or refers to someone else being abused).
- Another person reports abuse.
- Observations or signs indicate abuse or risk of abuse.

IMPLEMENTATION

The Head of the organisation must:

- Maintain current knowledge of the Reportable Conduct Scheme and subscribe to updates from the Commission for Children and Young People (CCYP).
- Ensure systems are in place to prevent child abuse, manage allegations, and support safe reporting processes.
- Notify the CCYP within three business days of becoming aware of a reportable allegation using the CCYP online notification form.
- Contact Victoria Police immediately if criminal conduct is suspected, noting that police investigations take precedence over internal investigations.
- Begin and oversee an internal investigation using the CCYP Investigation Guide, ensuring risks to children are managed throughout.
- Maintain detailed and objective records of all stages of the investigation and provide progress updates to the Commission as required.
- Submit a full investigation report to the CCYP within 30 calendar days, including findings and actions taken.
- Classify findings appropriately as substantiated, unsubstantiated, unfounded, or outside the scheme, with clear reasoning and evidence.
- Seek advice from the Commission (8601 5281 or childsafestandards@ccyp.vic.gov.au) if clarification or guidance is needed.
- Ensure all relevant staff understand that the Reportable Conduct Scheme does not replace the requirement to report allegations to Victoria Police.

Management/nominated supervisors/responsible persons will ensure:

- Ensure all staff and volunteers understand their obligations under the Reportable Conduct Scheme and are aware of who the Head of the Organisation is.
- Maintain systems that support prevention, reporting, and response to allegations of child abuse or reportable conduct.
- Confirm all employees hold current Working with Children Checks (WWCC) and adhere to child protection and safety policies.
- Immediately report any allegations or concerns of reportable conduct to the Head of the Organisation.
- Notify the CCYP directly if the Head of the Organisation fails to do so.
- Support staff and children throughout any investigation process while maintaining confidentiality and procedural fairness.

Educators will ensure:

- Understand their duty of care obligations and the requirements of the Reportable Conduct Scheme.
- Hold a current Working with Children Check and comply with all relevant child protection and reportable conduct policies.
- Report any allegations, suspicions, or concerns of reportable conduct immediately to the Head of the Organisation or Nominated Supervisor.
- Notify the CCYP if management or the Head of the Organisation fails to take action on an alleged incident.
- Cooperate fully with investigations and maintain confidentiality at all times.
- Recognise that failure to meet the obligations of the Reportable Conduct Scheme may result in the loss of their WWCC and disciplinary action.

SICK CHILDREN POLICY

Children come into contact with many other children and adults in the Education and Care environment, causing them to contract infectious illnesses. The National Quality Standard requires Education and Care services to implement specific strategies to minimise the spread of infectious illness.

PURPOSE
We aim to maintain the health of all children, staff, and their families, ensuring a healthy environment and minimising cross contamination and the spread of infectious illnesses.

IMPLEMENTATION
Our Service promotes the health and safety of children, families, and staff by preventing and managing illness effectively. Children who are unwell must remain at home to prevent the spread of infection.
Educators are not medical practitioners; if illness is suspected, families will be asked to collect their child and may need to provide a medical clearance before returning.

DEFINITIONS
Chain of Infection (Definition Summary)
Source: Germs from an infected person or environment.
Transmission: Spread via air, contact, or contaminated surfaces.
Infection: Germs enter another person through the mouth, respiratory tract, skin, or wounds.

Regular cleaning, handwashing, and immunisation break the chain at any stage.

When a Child is Unwell
Children will not be accepted if they:
- Are too unwell to participate in normal activities, or
- Have a contagious illness or disease.

If a Child Becomes Ill at the Service
- Symptoms are monitored and recorded.
- The child will rest in a supervised quiet area.
- Parents/guardians are contacted for immediate collection.
- Children with vomiting or diarrhoea must remain home for 48 hours after symptoms cease.
- A doctor's certificate is required after vomiting, diarrhoea, or infectious illness.

Exclusion and Notification
- Exclusion periods follow Staying Healthy: Preventing Infectious Diseases in Early Childhood Education and Care.
- Families will be informed of any outbreak with details of symptoms and exclusion timeframes.
- Unimmunised children may be excluded during outbreaks in accordance with the Control of Infectious Diseases Policy.
- The Public Health Unit (PHU) must be notified immediately if a child is diagnosed with a vaccine-preventable disease (e.g. measles, whooping cough, mumps, tetanus, etc.) or if there are two or more cases of gastrointestinal or respiratory illness.

Management/nominated supervisors/responsible persons will ensure:
- Ensure effective illness prevention and infection control procedures are implemented and regularly reviewed.
- Provide educators with training, guidance, and resources on managing infectious illness, hygiene practices, and exclusion periods.
- Maintain and update the service's illness register, immunisation records, and parent contact details.
- Ensure exclusion periods follow current *Staying Healthy* guidelines and that families are promptly notified of any outbreaks or exposure to infectious diseases.
- Notify the Public Health Unit (PHU) immediately when a vaccine-preventable disease or outbreak (e.g. two or more cases of gastrointestinal or respiratory illness) occurs.
- Support educators in enforcing health exclusion requirements and ensure that children return only with appropriate medical clearance when required.
- Ensure all cleaning and hygiene supplies are available and that cleaning schedules are strictly followed.

Educators will ensure:
- Monitor children for signs of illness (e.g. fever, vomiting, diarrhoea, rashes, lethargy) and document observations in the illness record.
- Isolate unwell children in a quiet, supervised area while waiting for collection and provide comfort and reassurance.
- Notify families immediately if a child becomes unwell and request prompt collection.

- Maintain a 48-hour exclusion period for children who experience vomiting or diarrhoea, and request medical clearance for return after any infectious illness.
- Follow strict hygiene and cleaning procedures to prevent cross-contamination, including handwashing, disinfecting surfaces, and safe handling of bodily fluids.
- Inform management of any suspected infectious illness or outbreak and assist in notifying families.
- Report serious illnesses, injuries, or incidents to management for regulatory notification within 24 hours.
- Model and encourage effective hygiene practices with children throughout the day.

Families will ensure:

- Monitor their child's health and keep them home if they are unwell or showing symptoms of infectious illness.
- Collect their child promptly when notified by the service that they are unwell.
- Provide up-to-date immunisation records and inform the service of any changes to their child's health or medical condition.
- Follow exclusion timeframes outlined by the service or health authorities and provide a doctor's clearance after vomiting, diarrhoea, or contagious illness before returning.
- Support the service's illness prevention procedures by reinforcing hygiene and health habits at home.

SUPERVISION POLICY

"Supervision is an integral part of the whole care and education experience. At its most basic level, supervision helps to protect children from hazards or harm that may arise in their daily experiences in play, interactions with others, and daily routines" (Victoria Department of Education and Training, 2010, p.1)

PURPOSE

Educators have a duty of care to ensure children are supervised at all times, maintaining a safe and secure environment adhering to National Regulations. Supervision, together with thoughtful design and arrangement of children's environments, assists in the prevention and severity of injury to children.

Educators will actively supervise children, identifying risks and taking all necessary steps to prevent or minimise injury. Effective supervision of children also provides Educators with the opportunity to support and build on children's play experiences.

IMPLEMENTATION

Management and/or the Nominated Supervisor will

- Design and maintain the service environment to ensure clear visibility and safe supervision of all children while respecting privacy and dignity.
- Maintain compliance with required **educator-to-child ratios** — 1:15 for general activities and 1:4 for water-based activities.
- Ensure educators under 18 years of age are always supervised by an educator over 18 and never left alone with children.
- Confirm all educators meet minimum qualification and training requirements in accordance with the **National Regulations**.
- Notify **Regulatory Authorities** within 24 hours of any serious incident or injury.
- Develop, review, and implement **Supervision Plans** for both indoor and outdoor areas that identify high-risk zones and support effective educator positioning.
- Develop and maintain staff rosters that ensure consistent and adequate supervision at all times, including during excursions and rest periods.
- Conduct **risk assessments** for excursions and activities, identifying supervision requirements, ratios, and safe movement plans.
- Ensure families are notified within 24 hours of any incident involving their child, and that reports are recorded accurately.
- Regularly review supervision strategies, incident reports, and the physical environment to identify areas for improvement.

Educators will

- Understand and uphold their **duty of care** to ensure the safety and wellbeing of every child.
- Follow all supervision plans and actively position themselves to maintain sight and hearing of all children at all times.
- Continuously **scan the environment**, move regularly to cover blind spots, and adjust positions as activities or risks change.
- Avoid distractions — personal phone use, extended conversations, or administrative work while supervising.
- Communicate effectively with other educators regarding supervision coverage, particularly when moving away from a group.
- Support new and relief educators to understand supervision expectations and environmental layout.
- Maintain correct ratios and record attendance accurately throughout the day and during transitions.
- Supervise rest and sleep periods in accordance with the **Sleep and Rest Policy**, ensuring children remain visible and safe.
- Keep hazardous items, equipment, and substances out of children's reach at all times.
- Intervene immediately if unsafe play or risky behaviour is observed, using guidance and redirection to maintain safety.
- Model and promote safe, respectful behaviour during all interactions and activities.

TERMINATION OF ENROLMENT POLICY

Management and staff are committed to maintaining respectful partnerships with families to support children's inclusion and wellbeing. While every effort is made to work collaboratively with families, enrolment may be terminated if ongoing breaches of policy or behaviour compromise the safety or wellbeing of others.

PURPOSE

All children have the right to quality education and care in a safe and supportive environment (Quality Area 2, ACECQA).

We are legally obligated to ensure the health, safety, and wellbeing of children, families, and staff. Families are informed during orientation of their responsibilities and the Service's right to terminate enrolment for policy breaches.

Behaviour management

Educators will always use positive guidance and family collaboration to address behavioural issues. If a child's behaviour remains harmful or disruptive despite support strategies, and the safety of others is at risk, the Service may request the family to withdraw their child.

Service policies

The Service may terminate enrolment where a family or child breaches policy or agreement, including:

- Failure to comply with the enrolment contract or fee payment.
- Ongoing unsafe or disruptive behaviour despite support.
- Repeated late collection.
- Lack of family support in meeting a child's individual needs.
- Disrespectful or abusive behaviour towards staff or families.
- Providing false or incomplete information.
- Non-compliance with health, immunisation, or custody requirements.
- Bringing an ill child to the Service.

Termination notification

Families will receive written notice following all reasonable efforts to address non-compliance.
Immediate termination may occur if the safety of children, staff, or families is at risk.
Outstanding fees remain payable upon termination.

IMPLEMENTATION

Management and/or the Nominated Supervisor will

- Ensure families understand policies and conditions at enrolment.
- Communicate clearly about concerns and provide written notice before termination where possible.
- Document all discussions and actions taken.
- Seek external support to maintain inclusion where appropriate.
- Ensure termination decisions are fair, consistent, and legally compliant.
- Provide written termination details and fee information.
- Maintain confidentiality and review termination cases for ongoing improvement.

Educators will

- Support inclusion through positive relationships and guidance.
- Record and report concerning behaviour or policy breaches.
- Collaborate with families and management to develop behaviour support plans.
- Follow relevant policies (Behaviour Management, Inclusion, Additional Needs).
- Maintain professionalism and confidentiality.
- Remind families of key policies and report persistent non-compliance to management.

WATER SAFETY POLICY

The safety and supervision of children is paramount when in or around water. This relates to water play, excursions near water, hot water, drinking water and hygiene practices with water in the Service environment. Children will be supervised at all times during water play experiences.

PURPOSE

To ensure the safety and supervision of children in and around water. This includes water play, excursions near water, hot water, drinking water and hygiene practices with water in the Service environment.

IMPLEMENTATION

Management/nominated supervisor/ responsible person will:

- Provide clear guidance, training, and resources to educators, staff, and families about water safety and supervision in and around water.
- Ensure the Service's health and safety practices include procedures for safe water storage, water play, and managing potential water hazards.
- Conduct and document a risk assessment before any excursion involving proximity to water, ensuring supervision ratios meet or exceed regulatory requirements.
- Ensure that at least one educator with current approved first aid, CPR, and anaphylaxis qualifications is present whenever children are near water or on excursions.
- Regularly inspect and maintain facilities to ensure that hot water systems and sources are inaccessible to children.
- Confirm that water hazards such as ponds, tanks, or features have adequate barriers or covers to prevent child access.
- Monitor compliance with this policy through routine safety checks, supervision plans, and educator communication.
- Review water safety procedures annually and following any incident to ensure ongoing compliance with the National Regulations.

Educators will:

- Actively supervise children near water at all times, maintaining visual contact and remaining within arm's reach when necessary.
- Ensure fish ponds, water features, and any standing water are safely guarded, fenced, or covered when not directly supervised.
- Conduct daily safety inspections of indoor and outdoor areas to identify water hazards, completing a risk assessment where concerns arise and excluding children from unsafe areas until rectified.
- Plan and implement water play experiences safely and appropriately for weather and developmental stages, ensuring water troughs are filled only to safe levels and emptied after each use.
- Store buckets, basins, and other containers used for cleaning or soaking out of children's reach and ensure they are emptied immediately after use.
- Discourage children from drinking water used for play activities and use these experiences to teach safe water behaviours.
- Educate children about water safety, including the difference between drinking water, water play, and stored water.
- Ensure pet water bowls are changed daily and only accessible when educators are present to supervise.
- Model and reinforce safe water practices at all times, incorporating discussions on safety into the educational program.

ENVIRONMENTALLY RESPONSIBLE POLICY

Our Service encourages the awareness of environmental responsibility and implements practices that contribute to a sustainable future. Children are supported to become environmentally responsible and show respect for the environment. We practice and promote sustainability through reducing waste, minimising consumption, and protecting and conserving wildlife and natural habitats.

PURPOSE

We believe in educating children about being environmentally responsible which is promoted and supported through daily practices, resource and interactions. Sustainable practice is encouraged within the Service and community, assisting children and families to become advocates for a sustainable future.

IMPLEMENTATION

Teaching and learning about being environmentally responsible starts with everyday practice. We believe being environmentally responsible should be embedded into the operations of the Service, rather than being a tokenistic 'theme' that is investigated every now and then. Our Service is committed to protecting our environment to ensure a sustainable future for our children. This involves Educators, children and families working together to protect our environment as we educate children about the importance of being environmentally responsible within our everyday practice.

Management will:

- Network with local community and environmental groups to stay informed on sustainable practices.
- Promote and model environmental responsibility across all areas of Service operation.
- Review policies and procedures regularly to identify and implement more sustainable practices (e.g. reusable hand towels, digital communication).
- Reduce paper use by prioritising electronic communication for newsletters, billing, and family correspondence.
- Conduct environmental audits to monitor and improve sustainable outcomes.
- Source recycled, reclaimed, or second-hand materials (e.g. from Reverse Garbage) for use in the Service.
- Ensure sustainable practices are embedded into daily routines and curriculum.
- Provide and maintain clearly labelled colour-coded bins for waste, recycling, and organics.
- Allocate budget resources to support sustainability initiatives such as composting, water collection, or LED upgrades.
- Liaise with families and educators to share sustainability goals and progress.
- Display the Service's sustainability achievements and goals for transparency and community engagement.

Educators will:

- Incorporate sustainable practices into everyday routines such as recycling, composting, and waste reduction.
- Model environmentally responsible behaviour for children and families.
- Include sustainability education in the curriculum—linking experiences to the "My Time, Our Place" Learning Framework outcomes.
- Encourage children to participate in eco-friendly projects such as gardening, composting, and water conservation.
- Facilitate discussions with children about caring for the environment, recycling, and protecting wildlife.
- Share sustainability information with families and encourage sustainable practices at home.
- Use visual aids and labels (e.g. colour-coded bins) to help children understand recycling and waste separation.
- Implement energy-saving actions, such as turning off lights, heaters, and air conditioning when not in use.
- Promote water conservation—use collected rainwater for gardens or reuse water play water outdoors.
- Engage children in nature-based play using natural and recycled materials (e.g. sticks, boxes, stones).
- Maintain worm farms and composting systems with children's involvement.
- Collaborate with colleagues, families, and community experts to improve environmental awareness and sustainable practice.
- Reflect sustainability principles in programming, documentation, and learning environments.

ANIMAL AND PET POLICY

Having a relationship with a pet and/or animal can help children develop a caring disposition and skills such as nurturing, responsibility, empathy and improved communication. Having a pet in an Education and Care environment enables children who are not otherwise exposed to animals learn these skills. The pet will become part of the regular educational program and lead to activities and learning about other animals.

PURPOSE

Having animals at the Service enhances children's learning by fostering empathy, responsibility, and respect for living things. This policy ensures that all interactions with animals occur safely, hygienically, and humanely while supporting children's development and understanding of nature.

IMPLEMENTATION

The National Quality Standard encourages educators to foster respect for the natural environment and an understanding of the interdependence between people, plants, animals, and the land.

Having pets within the Service helps children learn responsibility, empathy, and care for living things. Interacting with animals supports children's social and emotional development, builds communication and observation skills, and provides hands-on science and nature learning experiences.

While pets offer many benefits, educators must also ensure the health, safety, and wellbeing of both children and animals through responsible supervision and care practices.

Assessing and managing risks

Before introducing or allowing contact with any animal, a risk assessment must be conducted to ensure the health, safety, and wellbeing of both children and animals. Considerations include the animal's temperament, health status, supervision requirements, hygiene measures, and the ability to meet the animal's long-term care needs.

Disease

As animals can spread disease, access to animals at the Service requires special consideration to prevent this. Health authorities identify that germs can be present on the skin, hair, feathers and scales, and in the faeces, urine and saliva of animals. While these germs may not cause disease in the animal, they may cause disease in humans.

Effective hand washing and cleaning

Children and adults should employ effective hand washing after touching or feeding animals, or cleaning their bedding, tanks, cages or enclosures. However it is important to engage children with these tasks as they learn responsibility through 'hands on' learning experiences.

Appropriate supervision

Children should also be appropriately supervised when they have contact with animals to avoid potential injury or harm to the child or the animal.

Service pets

- The rationale and long-term implications of keeping a pet will be discussed with management, educators, and families before introduction.
- Pets must have clean enclosures, fresh food and water, and safe, hygienic living conditions.
- Food and cleaning supplies for pets must be stored securely and out of children's reach.
- Children and staff must wash hands after handling animals.
- Only animals approved by the Nominated Supervisor may reside at the Service.
- Animal care and welfare education will be included in the Service program.

Visits from children's pets

- Families must seek written permission from the Nominated Supervisor before bringing a pet for a visit.
- A risk assessment will be completed prior to approval.
- Pets visiting the Service must be removed immediately after the visit and must not be left unattended.

Pests & vermin

- Pest control will at the Service will be organised and maintained by the school's administrators.
- When pests or vermin are present, the schools pest and vermin policy will be followed by all educators.

BULLYING, DISCRIMINATION AND HARASSMENT POLICY

Our Service is committed to creating a workplace with vision and meaningful direction, adhering to our code of conduct and practicing ethical behaviour to ensure a productive work environment free from bullying, discrimination, and/or harassment.

PURPOSE

We are committed to providing a safe, respectful, and equitable workplace for all staff and educators. Bullying, discrimination, and harassment are not tolerated. Our Service upholds the Early Childhood Code of Ethics, Fair Work requirements, and our philosophy to ensure a positive, safe, and supportive environment for everyone.

IMPLEMENTATION

Everyone has the right to a safe and respectful workplace free from bullying, discrimination, and harassment. Our Service is committed to fostering an environment where all staff, families, and visitors are treated with dignity and respect.

Workplace bullying occurs when a person or group repeatedly behaves unreasonably towards another, creating a risk to health, safety, or wellbeing. This may include aggressive or intimidating behaviour, spreading rumours, excluding others, unreasonable work demands, displaying offensive material, or pressuring someone to act inappropriately. Reasonable management action carried out fairly is not bullying.

Discrimination and harassment occur when a person is treated unfairly or subjected to unwelcome behaviour based on characteristics such as age, gender, disability, race, religion, or sexual orientation. These actions are unlawful under anti-discrimination and workplace laws.

Our Service follows its Philosophy, Code of Conduct, and the Early Childhood Code of Ethics to guide professional behaviour and ensure a positive, inclusive, and safe environment for everyone.

Management and Nominated Supervisor will ensure:

- All new employees receive a **comprehensive induction** covering the Code of Conduct, Grievance Policy, and the Early Childhood Australia Code of Ethics.
- The **Bullying, Discrimination and Harassment Policy** and related procedures are **reviewed annually**, and all staff understand that inappropriate behaviour will not be tolerated.
- Concerns or complaints about bullying or discrimination are **managed promptly, confidentially, and fairly** in accordance with Service procedures.
- Staff receive **ongoing professional development** to promote positive communication, inclusive practice, and awareness of legal obligations.
- All educators have **clear job descriptions**, performance expectations, and access to constructive feedback through meetings and appraisals.
- **Open, respectful communication** and teamwork are promoted to foster a positive and inclusive workplace culture.
- All educators and staff are treated **fairly and equitably**, with management demonstrating compliance with **anti-discrimination and workplace legislation**.
- **Records and meetings** relating to conduct, performance, or complaints are accurately documented and stored securely.

Educators will:

- Work collaboratively with colleagues and management, understanding their **roles and responsibilities** as outlined in their job descriptions.
- Demonstrate **respect for diversity**, valuing the unique skills, strengths, and perspectives of others to foster a positive, professional environment.
- Adhere to all relevant **anti-discrimination and workplace conduct laws** and Service policies.
- Take **responsibility for their own conduct**, ensuring interactions are professional, respectful, and free from harassment or discrimination.
- **Report concerns or inappropriate behaviour** early to management or the Nominated Supervisor to allow timely resolution.
- Provide **specific and factual information** when reporting a bullying or harassment concern and cooperate with the process of fair investigation.
- Maintain **confidentiality** at all times, refraining from discussing or sharing information about complaints or investigations with others.
- Promote a **supportive, inclusive, and safe workplace**, modelling positive behaviour and communication with all colleagues, families, and children.

GRIEVANCE POLICY (STAFF)

Feedback from families, educators, staff, and the community supports continuous improvement in the quality of our Service. We recognise that differing opinions may arise and are committed to managing grievances fairly, confidentially, and respectfully.

PURPOSE

To ensure all complaints and grievances are handled with fairness, equity, and transparency, fostering a safe and harmonious workplace guided by procedural fairness, respect, and our Service philosophy.

Procedural fairness and natural justice

All parties involved in a grievance have:

- The right to be heard,
- The right to an unbiased decision, and
- The right to a decision based on relevant evidence.

Conflict Resolution Process

1) Discuss the issue privately and respectfully with the person involved.
2) If unresolved, refer the issue to the Nominated Supervisor or Approved Provider for mediation.
3) Management will investigate and provide a written outcome within seven days.
4) If unresolved, external mediation may be sought.

IMPLEMENTATION

Grievances are addressed promptly, confidentially, and professionally. The process encourages open communication, early resolution, and positive relationships between staff.

DEFINITIONS

Complaint: A minor issue or expression of dissatisfaction (verbal or written) that can be resolved within 24 hours and does not require a formal investigation — for example, concerns about service quality. Complaints exclude staff or industrial matters unless they directly affect child safety.

Grievance: A formal complaint involving more serious issues that cannot be immediately resolved — for example, an alleged breach of regulations or risk to a child's wellbeing.

Mediator: A neutral person who helps parties in conflict reach a fair and respectful agreement.

Mediation: A structured process where an independent party supports people in conflict to reach a peaceful and constructive resolution.

Notifiable complaint: A complaint alleging a breach of the Education and Care Services National Law, National Regulations, or National Quality Standard, or any matter that may compromise the health, safety, or wellbeing of a child.
Such complaints must be reported to the Department of Early Childhood Education and Care within 24 hours (Section 174(2)(b), Regulation 176(2)(b)).

Serious incident: Any event involving:

- The death, injury, trauma, or illness of a child requiring (or that should have required) medical or emergency attention; or
- A child who is missing, unaccounted for, wrongly removed, or locked in/out of the premises.
  Serious incidents must be recorded in the *Incident, Injury, Trauma and Illness Record* and reported to the Regulatory Authority within 24 hours (Regulation 176(2)(a)).

The Approved Provider/ Nominated Supervisor will:

- Treat all grievances seriously, confidentially, and without bias.
- Investigate impartially and communicate outcomes within seven working days.
- Keep records securely and monitor outcomes.
- Ensure no person is victimised or bullied for raising a grievance.
- Notify the Department if a complaint concerns child safety or wellbeing.

Educators will:

- Raise issues respectfully and directly with the person involved when possible.
- Escalate unresolved or serious concerns to the Nominated Supervisor or Approved Provider.
- Maintain confidentiality and professionalism throughout the process.
- Avoid involving others not directly related to the grievance.

STAFFING ARRANGEMENTS POLICY (INCL. SINGLE STAFF)

Our Service is committed to maintaining high-quality education and care by employing qualified and experienced educators who foster nurturing, safe, and inclusive environments. We ensure all staffing arrangements—whether single or dual staff—protect children's health, safety, and wellbeing, meeting National Law and Regulation requirements at all times.

PURPOSE

To ensure our Service operates in accordance with staffing qualifications, ratios, and supervision standards, while providing clear procedures for educators working independently in single-staff services.

IMPLEMENTATION

Our Service will comply with the required number of educators to children, taking into consideration qualification requirements and experience, in order to meet National Regulations and Standards. Whether single or dual-staff, the Service ensures educators have the tools, training, and communication support necessary to protect all children while maintaining their own safety and wellbeing.

Staffing Ratios and Qualifications

- The Service will comply with educator-to-child ratios and qualification requirements under the National Quality Framework.
- At least 50% of educators must hold (or be working towards) a Diploma-level qualification. Others must hold or be working towards an approved Certificate III.
- Educators actively working towards a qualification must provide documented evidence of enrolment and progress.

Dual-Staff and Single-Staff

- Dual-Staff Services:
  At least two educators are present and responsible for direct supervision, programming, and safety. Shared oversight enhances risk management, emergency response, and child engagement.
- Single-Staff Services:
  Operate with one educator present for a session. Additional safety and communication procedures apply to protect children and educators working alone.

Approved First Aid Qualifications

- Educators and Management are required to have an ACECQA approved first aid qualification, anaphylaxis management, and emergency asthma management training. Approved qualifications are published on the ACECQA website.
- It is the Staff and Educators responsibilities to ensure they maintain current First Aid, Asthma, and Anaphylaxis Training certificates, providing the Service with a copy of the certificate. Staff and educators must ensure they participate in training prior to the expiration date on their certificates.

Record Keeping

- Staff records must include qualifications, training, WWCC details, and attendance logs.
- All educators and visitors must sign in/out daily.
- Incident, injury, trauma, and illness records must be completed within 24 hours and stored per regulation.

Supervision

- Children must always be in sight and/or hearing of an educator.
- Supervision levels adjust according to group size, age, activity, and environment.
- Educators must position themselves strategically, especially during high-risk activities or near water.
- Supervision records, rosters, and floor plans must be maintained.

Implementation for Single-Staff Services

To strengthen safety and compliance in single-staff operations:

Safety and Environment

- The pickup/drop-off area must be well lit and clearly marked.
- Educators park in safe, visible areas and remain inside the facility until relief or family arrival.
- Doors remain locked until the educator identifies visitors or family members.

Communication and Risk Management

- Keep a charged mobile phone (or service phone) on person at all times with emergency numbers pre-programmed.
- Maintain contact with management, nearby services, or school staff for support.
- Conduct and review risk assessments every six months.

Emergencies and Illness

- Children must be aware of emergency and evacuation procedures.
- If an educator becomes unwell or an emergency arises, management must be contacted immediately.
- In serious cases, children should seek help from a nearby adult or call emergency services.

Toileting and Movement

- Children must ask permission before leaving the main area.
- Toileting outside the OSHC room should be supervised by accompanying all children or using a buddy system with responsible peers.

The Approved Provider/ Nominated Supervisor will:

- Ensure educator-to-child ratios and qualification requirements are always met.
- Verify and record Working With Children Checks, qualifications, and first aid certifications.
- Appoint and support a Nominated Supervisor and Educational Leader to guide practice and compliance.
- Develop rosters and supervision plans ensuring continuous coverage and safe staff-to-child ratios.
- Implement communication and risk procedures specific to single-staff services.
- Maintain emergency contact lists and ensure educators working alone have access to immediate support.
- Conduct regular audits, risk assessments, and WHS reviews for all service sites.
- Provide training, mentoring, and professional development for all educators.
- Ensure all incidents, injuries, and illnesses are reported, documented, and managed according to regulation.

Educators will:

- Maintain vigilant, active supervision of all children at all times.
- Follow approved rosters, supervision plans, and safety procedures.
- Adhere to single-staff safety protocols, keeping a phone on hand and maintaining contact with management.
- Report incidents, hazards, and safety concerns immediately.
- Engage in positive, professional communication with colleagues, families, and children.
- Keep records up to date, including WWCC, training certificates, and attendance logs.
- Model safe and responsible practices, including during arrival and departure times.
- Support children's understanding of safety through discussion and role modelling.
- Maintain confidentiality and comply with all Service policies and the Code of Conduct.
- Participate in risk assessments, drills, and ongoing professional learning.

RESPONSIBLE PERSON POLICY

A Responsible Person must be physically in attendance at all times that the Service is educating and caring for children.

Approved Providers are responsible for appointing a responsible person who is aged 18 years or older, has adequate knowledge and understanding of the provision of education and care to children, and have the ability to effectively supervise and manage an education and care service (ACECQA, 2017)

PURPOSE

Our Service is committed to meeting our duty of care obligations under the National Law & Regulations to ensure a Responsible Person is physically on the premises at all times children are being educated and cared for.

DEFINITIONS

Nominated Supervisor: A person with responsibility for the day-to-day management of an approved service. The Nominated Supervisor has a range of responsibilities under the Law and Regulations that govern the operation of education and care services.

Person in day-to-day charge (RPIC): A person who is physically at the service and has the role of Nominated Supervisor or duly appointed person. The Responsible Person has consented to be placed in day-to-day charge of the service but does not take on the responsibilities of the Nominated Supervisor rather, they ensure the consistency and continuity in practices.

IMPLEMENTATION

A Responsible Person will be present on the premises at all times when children are being educated and cared for. The current Responsible Person's name will be clearly displayed for families and visitors.

When the Responsible Person leaves the premises, duties will be formally handed over to another authorised staff member, with each handover documented. Both the outgoing and incoming Responsible Persons will ensure the displayed name is updated immediately.

The process for determining and transferring the Responsible Person role will be clearly communicated to all staff and strictly followed at all times.

A Responsible Person can be:

- The Approved Provider or a person with management or control
- A Nominated Supervisor *or*
- A person in day-to-day charge of the service (RPIC)

The Approved Provider/Management will ensure:

- Appoint and ensure presence: A Responsible Person (RP) is authorised, over 18, and physically on site at all times children are in care (open–close), with clear handover and sign on/off procedures.
- Verify fitness & capability: Confirm minimum qualifications/experience (incl. Child Protection training), current WWCC, proven ability to supervise/manage, and satisfactory compliance history and reference checks; keep written consent on file. *(Diploma or higher recommended.)*
- Meet notification duties: Notify the Regulatory Authority via NQA ITS of Nominated Supervisor (NS) appointments and changes (start/finish, name/contact changes, removal/withdrawal) within required timeframes; remove any RP who no longer meets requirements.
- Record & display: Keep the staff register showing who is the RP for each period.

A Nominated Supervisor/ appointed Responsible Person will:

- Accept and document the role: Provide written consent, sign the staff register with start/finish times, and ensure the RP name is displayed while on duty.
- Fulfil the role and conditions: Maintain required checks/competencies, follow any conditions, and arrange prompt handover/notification of absences so another authorised RP assumes duty.
- Notify authorities (NS only): Advise the Regulatory Authority within 7 days of personal/status changes affecting fitness (e.g., WWCC/registration issues, address, disciplinary action), and notify management in writing if withdrawing consent to be RP.

BEHAVIOUR GUIDANCE POLICY

Children have the right to positive guidance in a supportive, respectful environment, as outlined in the National Regulations. Through facing challenges, they develop self-regulation and positive traits such as resilience and perseverance. Understanding acceptable behaviour helps children manage their actions and interactions across different social and emotional settings.

PURPOSE

We aim to build positive, trusting relationships with children, helping them feel safe, secure, and supported within our Service. Educators treat all children with respect and fairness, guiding them to develop the skills needed for socially and culturally appropriate behaviour.

Supporting children's self-regulation and positive behaviour is a shared goal between educators and families, aligned with the *My Time, Our Place* Framework, the *Education and Care Services National Regulations*, and the *National Quality Standard (NQS)*.

DEFINITIONS

Self-regulation: The ability to manage energy states, emotions, behaviour and attention: the ability to return to a balanced, calm and constant state of being. Self-regulation is a key factor for mental health, wellbeing and learning.

IMPLEMENTATION

Our Service promotes positive behaviour by providing a safe, supportive, and inclusive environment that values each child's safety, dignity, and individuality.

Educators recognise that developing self-regulation is a key part of social and emotional growth. We set clear, consistent boundaries within nurturing relationships to help children feel secure and confident.

Positive behaviour is encouraged through three key approaches:

1. A supportive learning environment with developmentally appropriate experiences and resources.
2. Age-appropriate strategies that build social and emotional skills and reinforce positive behaviour.
3. Guidance techniques that respectfully redirect or reduce undesired behaviour.

Management/Nominated Supervisor/Responsible Person will ensure:

- Collect information from families about each child's social skills and preferences to plan experiences that build social and decision-making abilities.
- Collaborate with families, schools, and support agencies to develop and maintain inclusion or behaviour support plans (e.g. SIP) for children with additional needs.
- Encourage and acknowledge positive choices and model proactive strategies that teach appropriate behaviour and consequences.
- Ensure consistent communication with families regarding significant or ongoing behaviours.
- Support and train educators to strengthen their skills in behaviour guidance and review the effectiveness of strategies regularly.

Educators will:

- Foster each child's social and emotional development, guiding them to understand emotions, empathy, and acceptable behaviour.
- Model and encourage positive interactions, communication, and problem-solving among children.
- Use calm, positive guidance techniques such as redirection and reflection, adjusting the environment or program when needed.
- Record and report serious or repeated incidents, working with families to develop or review the child's Strategic Inclusion Plan (SIP).
- Collaborate with families and professionals to ensure consistent approaches, using respectful communication that supports self-esteem and emotional regulation.

Families will:

- Collaborate with educators and professional agencies to develop a shared understanding of their child's behaviour and communicate any recent events that may influence it.
- Review, agree to, and support Behavioural Safety Plans or Strategic Inclusion Plans developed for their child.
- Work in partnership with educators to apply consistent behaviour guidance strategies at home and within the Service.
- Maintain open, respectful communication with educators about their child's progress, challenges, and behavioural development.
- Support the Service's decisions and strategies aimed at ensuring the safety and wellbeing of all children.

Children will:

- Learn to respect the rights and needs of others and understand how their behaviour affects those around them.
- Receive positive guidance to recognise acceptable behaviour and manage conflicts using words instead of actions.
- Develop empathy by learning about feelings, fairness, and the consequences of their actions.
- Build social and communication skills by greeting others, sharing resources, helping with routines, and using good manners.
- Practice patience by waiting for their turn and engaging in cooperative, respectful, and inclusive play.

Positive behaviour strategies:

Our Service will:

- Build positive, respectful relationships with children to create a sense of trust, safety, and belonging.
- Use Elysium's values-based behaviour guidance strategies to model empathy, respect, and cooperation.
- Empower children to express emotions through calm, non-hurtful communication and reflective dialogue.
- Apply restorative practices to help children understand the impact of their actions, repair harm, and restore relationships.
- Encourage independence, decision-making, and self-regulation through supportive guidance and consistent routines.
- Set clear, fair limits and follow through consistently, engaging children in creating shared expectations.
- Provide stimulating, age-appropriate environments and activities that foster engagement, inclusion, and a sense of purpose.
- Acknowledge children's efforts and achievements, using positive feedback to strengthen self-esteem and social responsibility.

BEHAVIOUR GUIDANCE: BULLYING POLICY

Bullying can occur among children of any age, gender, or background, and requires adult guidance to prevent and address effectively. Educators are responsible for fostering a safe, respectful environment, developing strategies for prevention, and responding fairly to all allegations.

The *My Time, Our Place* Framework highlights the importance of secure, respectful, and reciprocal relationships. Positive relationships between children, educators, and families support each child's sense of belonging, safety, and identity, forming the foundation for a caring and inclusive community.

PURPOSE

To create a safe and healthy environment for children where bullying behaviours are not tolerated. As reflected in our Service philosophy and Learning Framework (MTOP), Educators will encourage positive relationships between children and their peers.

IMPLEMENTATION

Our Service maintains a zero-tolerance approach to bullying. The safety and wellbeing of the child being bullied is always the first priority. While the causes of bullying behaviour may be explored, they do not outweigh the need to protect and support the victim. Educators will promote a safe, inclusive, and respectful environment where children are encouraged to express their feelings, resolve conflict positively, and build empathy.

Management/Nominated Supervisor/Responsible Person will ensure:

- Ensure educators understand and implement Elysium's values-based and restorative approaches to addressing bullying.
- Promote consistent supervision and support educators in identifying early signs of bullying.
- Ensure all allegations or disclosures of bullying are taken seriously, investigated promptly, and documented.
- Communicate outcomes with families involved and provide access to appropriate support services where required.
- Regularly review supervision practices, staff training, and the program environment to minimise opportunities for bullying.

Educators will:

- Supervise actively and observe children's interactions for signs of bullying or social exclusion.
- Listen attentively and respond sensitively to any child disclosing bullying, reassuring them it is not their fault.
- Model empathy, respect, and inclusion in all interactions with children and colleagues.
- Support children to manage emotions, build friendships, and use positive, non-hurtful communication.
- Record and report any suspected or confirmed incidents of bullying to the Nominated Supervisor immediately.
- Communicate with families to provide consistent strategies that reinforce respectful behaviour both at home and within the Service.

SANCTIONS

Possible sanctions will be dependent on each individual case, but may include:

- a warning.
- temporary exclusion from the Service
- permanent exclusion from the Service (Termination of Enrolment Policy)

INTERACTIONS WITH CHILDREN, FAMILIES & STAFF POLICY

Secure, respectful, and reciprocal relationships with children are one of the principles that underpin the work that we do. Within the educations and care community, many different relationships are negotiated with and between children, educators, and families. The way in which these relationships are established and maintained, and the way in which they remain visible impacts on how the industry as a whole. Relationships directly effect how children form their own identity, whether or not they feel safe and supported, and ultimately, their sense of belonging.

PURPOSE

We aim to build positive relationships with children, families, and educators through collaboration and interactions, which is reflective of our Service philosophy and the Early Years Learning Framework. Educators will encourage positive relationships between children and their peers as well as with educators and families at the Service, ensuring children feel safe and supported.

IMPLEMENTATION

In order to build and maintain positive and respectful relationships with children, families and Educators of our Service will adhere to our philosophy and Code of Ethics to guide:

Interactions with Children

Children need positive relationships with Educators that are trusting and responsive to their needs.

Interactions with Families

Effective communication is central to building and maintaining positive relationships. Educators will demonstrate mutual respect, value each other's contributions, and model the positive communication we wish to see in children. By engaging families and siblings with empathy and respect, our Service fosters a responsive, inclusive, and supportive environment for all.

Interactions with Staff and Educators

The Service recognises that the way Educators interact with each other has an effect on the interactions they have with children and families.

Management/Nominated Supervisor/Responsible Person will ensure:

- Create a welcoming, respectful environment that promotes positive relationships between children, families, and educators.
- Lead by example through professional, empathetic communication and fair treatment of all staff and families.
- Provide clear guidance, constructive feedback, and regular opportunities for professional growth and reflection.
- Facilitate open communication through meetings, updates, and accessible information for families and educators.
- Support educators in developing children's confidence, social skills, and resilience through restorative and strengths-based practices.
- Ensure policies and procedures about communication, behaviour, and grievances are up to date and implemented consistently.
- Engage with families respectfully, valuing their input and cultural backgrounds, and seek external support where necessary to meet individual needs.

Educators will:

- Build trusting, respectful, and genuine relationships with children, families, and colleagues.
- Communicate positively and professionally, using empathy, active listening, and appropriate language in all interactions.
- Support children's emotional and social development by guiding behaviour positively, encouraging empathy, and respecting individual differences.
- Collaborate with colleagues through open dialogue, shared responsibility, and constructive feedback to maintain a cohesive team.
- Uphold confidentiality, professionalism, and fairness when working with families and each other.
- Reflect regularly on their communication and interactions to strengthen relationships and improve practice.
- Engage in professional learning to enhance teamwork, communication, and child-centred approaches.

RESPECT FOR CHILDREN POLICY

Strong, visible relationships between children, educators, and families are central to how an education and care community functions. These relationships shape children's sense of identity, safety, support, and belonging.

PURPOSE

The *My Time, Our Place* Framework identifies secure, respectful, and reciprocal relationships as essential to children's learning and wellbeing. Guided by our philosophy, educators build positive, respectful relationships that foster each child's self-esteem, confidence, and sense of belonging.

IMPLEMENTATION

All children have the right to feel accepted, respected, and connected to their culture and community, fostering identity and belonging. We aim to create a safe, secure environment where strong relationships with educators, children, and families support each child's wellbeing and development, in line with the National Quality Standard.

By teaching respect for cultural diversity, educators will assist children to:

- learn about their cultural background and develop a strong sense of self identity
- learn about and appreciate cultures and traditions other than their own
- learn to enjoy and respect differences and recognise universal characteristics we all share
- learn about racial prejudice and understand why it should be challenged

Management/Nominated Supervisor/Responsible Person will ensure:

- Create a warm, safe, and inclusive environment that values and respects each child's individuality.
- Support educators to build strong, respectful relationships with children and families through professional development and reflective practice.
- Ensure daily routines and mealtimes promote calm, respectful, and unhurried interactions.
- Encourage communication strategies that honour children's voices, home languages, and cultural backgrounds.
- Partner with families to support children's sense of belonging, confidence, and wellbeing.
- Model positive, respectful communication and ensure all staff uphold these practices.

Educators will:

- Interact with children using a positive, calm, and respectful tone at all times.
- Sit and engage with children during routines and experiences, fostering conversation and connection.
- Encourage children's independence and confidence by supporting them to express their ideas and seek help when needed.
- Respect and respond sensitively to each child's culture, values, and emotions.
- Model empathy, fairness, and respect, helping children build these qualities in their interactions with others.
- Provide a balance of planned and spontaneous experiences that support curiosity, inclusion, and learning.
- Support children to communicate effectively, work through differences, and understand diverse perspectives.
- Reflect regularly on their interactions to strengthen relationships and practice.

ENROLMENT POLICY

Enrolment and orientation is an exciting and emotional time for children and families. It is important to manage this time with sensitivity and support, building partnerships between families and the Service. Such partnerships enable the Service and families to work toward the common goal of promoting consistent quality outcomes for individual children and the Service.

PURPOSE

We aim to ensure children and families receive a positive and informative enrolment and orientation process that meets their individual needs. We strive to establish respectful and supportive relationships between families and the Service to promote positive outcomes for children whilst adhering to legislative requirements.

IMPLEMENTATION

Our Service accepts enrolments of children aged between 5 and 13 years of age.

Enrolments will be accepted providing:

- The service does not exceed its licensed capacity.
- A vacancy is available for the requested booking.
- Required educator-to-child ratios are maintained.
- Priority of access guidelines are met.

Priority of access

Priority is given to children:

- At risk of serious abuse or neglect.
- Of a sole parent or parents meeting the activity test through employment.

Children with disabilities will be enrolled where the service can meet their needs, with additional resources or funding arranged as required.

Enrolment

Families expressing interest in enrolment will:

- Be offered a tour and invited to discuss their child's individual needs.
- Provide required documentation, including medical plans, court orders, and immunisation records.
- Complete enrolment and Child Care Subsidy (CCS) requirements via *myGov*.
- Be given access to service information, including policies, philosophy, and fee structure.
- Be encouraged to share key words or phrases in their home language to support communication.
- Update personal or medical information as changes occur.

Orientation of the service

Where possible, families are encouraged to attend an orientation before starting. During orientation, families will:

- Tour the service and meet educators.
- Learn about daily routines, programs, and communication methods.
- Review key policies (e.g. fees, sun safety, illness, and medical procedures).
- Provide information about their child's needs and family goals.

In emergency or casual bookings, essential information will be gathered promptly to ensure safety and support.

Child care subsidy

- The Child Care Subsidy (CCS) is a means-tested payment reducing childcare fees.
- Families must complete their CCS assessment via *myGov* and confirm changes in their Complying Written Agreement (CWA).
- CCS payments go directly to the provider, and families pay the remaining balance.

Enrolment record keeping

All enrolment information and authorisations will be maintained according to the Record Keeping Policy.

On the child's first day:

- Families will be welcomed and supported by educators.
- The child will be introduced to their environment and daily routine.
- Management will ensure all required documentation is received and recorded.

Management/Nominated Supervisor will ensure:

- Ensure all enrolment documentation, medical plans, and legal records are complete before attendance.
- Confirm start dates and communicate child details (medical, developmental, and interests) with educators.
- Maintain accurate CCS and enrolment records in compliance systems.
- Ensure immunisation information is current and remind families to provide updates.
- Support families by explaining enrolment and subsidy processes.

- Ensure each new child is added to the observation and medical records cycle.

Educators will:

- Welcome families warmly and assist with orientation and settling in.
- Review child information prior to the start date to ensure individual needs are met.
- Communicate daily with families about routines, wellbeing, and engagement.
- Support children in transitioning smoothly into the program and building relationships.
- Ensure records of interactions and observations are completed and maintained accurately.
- Respect confidentiality and maintain cultural sensitivity at all times.

GRIEVANCE POLICY (FAMILIES)

Feedback from families, educators, staff and the wider community is fundamental in creating an evolving Childcare Service working towards the highest standard of care and education. It is foreseeable that feedback will include divergent views, which may result in complaints. This Policy details our Service's procedures for receiving and managing informal and formal complaints. Parents can lodge a grievance with management in the understanding that it will be managed conscientiously and confidentially.

PURPOSE

Our Service values open, respectful communication and recognises that differences in opinion may arise. We are committed to addressing all complaints and grievances promptly, fairly, and confidentially to ensure positive relationships between families, educators, and management.

This policy outlines a clear process for resolving issues while upholding procedural fairness, natural justice, and our Service's philosophy of respect, inclusion, and transparency.

DEFINITIONS

- Complaint: A minor issue or concern that can be resolved quickly (within 24 hours) without formal investigation.
- Grievance: A formal complaint involving more serious or ongoing matters requiring investigation and documentation.
- Mediator: A neutral person assisting parties to reach a fair resolution.
- Mediation: A structured process involving a third party supporting a peaceful settlement.
- Notifiable Complaint: A complaint alleging a breach of the National Law, National Regulations, or National Quality Standard, or any matter affecting a child's health, safety, or wellbeing. Must be reported within 24 hours.
- Serious Incident: An event involving death, injury, or trauma to a child requiring medical attention, or situations where a child is missing, unaccounted for, or wrongly removed. Must be reported to the Regulatory Authority within 24 hours.

IMPLEMENTATION

Procedural fairness and Natural Justice

All parties involved in a grievance have:

- The right to be heard.
- The right to an unbiased process.
- The right to a decision based on relevant evidence.

Conflict Resolution Process

1) Direct Discussion:
   Families are encouraged to first raise their concerns directly and respectfully with the relevant educator to allow for early resolution.
2) Escalation to Management:
   If the matter remains unresolved, the issue should be referred to the Nominated Supervisor or Approved Provider. Management will meet with the family to discuss the concern within 24 hours and begin an investigation if required.
3) Investigation and Response:
   Management will:
   - Investigate all sides of the issue impartially.
   - Keep all discussions confidential and professional.
   - Provide a written outcome within seven working days.
4) External Review:
   If the matter cannot be resolved internally, the family will be referred to the Department of Early Childhood Education and Care or another relevant external authority for further mediation or investigation.

Privacy and confidentiality

All complaints will be managed in accordance with the Privacy and Confidentiality Policy. If the complaint involves child protection or staff misconduct, appropriate external agencies will be informed.

The Approved Provider/ Nominated Supervisor will:

- Treat all grievances seriously, confidentially, and without bias.
- Acknowledge receipt of complaints within 24 hours.
- Investigate fairly, allowing all parties to present their perspective.
- Provide written outcomes within seven working days.
- Keep accurate and secure records of all grievances and outcomes.
- Protect families and staff from victimisation or retaliation.
- Report notifiable complaints or serious incidents to the Department within 24 hours.
- Monitor recurring issues to improve service quality and communication.

Educators will:

- Listen respectfully to families' concerns and clarify the issue.
- Record and document all relevant information accurately.
- Maintain confidentiality at all times.
- Support families in identifying possible solutions or external supports.
- Refer unresolved matters promptly to the Nominated Supervisor.
- Ensure interactions with families remain professional and empathetic.

Families will:

- Raise concerns directly with the relevant educator in the first instance.
- If unresolved, contact the Nominated Supervisor or Approved Provider for discussion.
- Submit formal grievances in writing when appropriate.
- Maintain confidentiality and respect throughout the process.
- Work collaboratively with educators and management to reach a fair resolution.

EVALUATION

To ensure grievances are handled appropriately and consistently, the Nominated Supervisor will:

- Review each complaint recorded in the Complaints and Grievance Register.
- Identify patterns or recurring issues for improvement.
- Evaluate the effectiveness of this policy annually with input from families, educators, and management.
- Ensure continuous improvement in communication and family engagement.

GOVERNANCE POLICY

The Governance Policy provides the overall direction, effectiveness, supervision and accountability of a Service. Management are responsible for guiding the direction of the service, ensuring that its goals and objectives are met in line with the philosophy, and all legal and regulatory requirements governing the operation of the service.

PURPOSE

Our Service aims to ensure all legal and financial requirements are implemented and recognised through appropriate governance practices, providing quality education and care, meeting the principles, practices and elements of the My Time, Our Place Learning Framework and the National Quality Standard.

IMPLEMENTATION

Governance is the process that directs and controls our Service, ensuring accountability, and supporting decision making.

The Approved Provider and Nominated Supervisor of the Service accept the legal responsibilities associated with establishing, administering, and maintaining the Service. Our Service has the following established positions:

Approved Provider	Matthew Hine
Nominated Supervisor	Matthew Hine, Anishia Williams
Educational Leader	Anishia Williams
Responsible Persons	Program Coordinators listed at the service

The approved provider is legally responsible for:

- Ensuring compliance with the Education and Care Services National Law and Regulations, Family Assistance Law, and other relevant state and federal legislation.
- Appointing and supporting a Nominated Supervisor, Educational Leader, and Coordinator/Director, ensuring they are fit and proper persons with completed background and Working With Children Checks.
- Providing adequate resources to support effective service operation and management.
- Maintaining up-to-date policies and procedures that meet legislative requirements and reflect the Service's philosophy and goals.
- Acting honestly, with due diligence and accountability in all governance matters.
- Overseeing recruitment, staff performance, qualifications, and compliance with the management hierarchy.
- Ensuring accurate and secure record keeping, including incident, injury, illness, and trauma records (retained per regulatory timelines).
- Maintaining financial viability through sound budgeting, reporting, and internal controls.
- Approving annual financial statements and meeting all funding and reporting obligations.
- Developing and annually reviewing the Quality Improvement Plan (QIP) and ensuring alignment with Service philosophy and learning frameworks.
- Establishing clear roles, responsibilities, and communication structures for management and staff.
- Supporting a collaborative, ethical culture guided by the Service's philosophy and continuous improvement processes.
- Ensuring the educational program aligns with My Time, Our Place: Framework for School Age Care in Australia, supporting each child's identity and wellbeing.

The nominated supervisor is responsible for:

- Adhering to the National Law and Regulations and upholding ethical and professional standards consistent with the Service's philosophy.
- Managing the daily operation of the Service, ensuring safe, inclusive, and compliant practices.
- Undertaking risk assessments and implementing effective risk management strategies.
- Ensuring consistent and transparent decision-making that builds confidence among families and staff.
- Supporting educators through supervision, training, and access to necessary resources.
- Delegating responsibilities appropriately and in writing, while maintaining accountability for outcomes.
- Monitoring educator compliance with Service policies, procedures, and professional standards.
- Communicating openly and regularly with the Approved Provider to ensure effective governance and collaboration.

Service philosophy

- The philosophy and statement of purpose will be collaboratively reviewed annually, reflecting the principles of My Time, Our Place and the values of children, families, and educators.
- All documents will include review dates and support the Service's continuous improvement goals.

Code of conduct

All staff and management must follow the Code of Conduct Policy, demonstrating integrity, professionalism, and ethical decision-making in all actions relating to confidentiality, duty of care, relationships, and resource use.

Confidentiality

- Confidential information must only be accessed or disclosed when required by law.
- No confidential material may be used for personal or financial gain or shared with unauthorised persons.
- All electronic communications are subject to the same confidentiality requirements as written records.
- The duty of confidentiality continues after employment or membership with the Service ends.

Ethical decision-making

All decisions will align with the Education and Care Services National Law and Regulations, the approved learning framework (MTOP), and the Service's policies and ethical standards.

Review and evaluation of the service

- Continuous reflection and evaluation will guide ongoing improvement.
- The Quality Improvement Plan (QIP) will include feedback from all stakeholders and identify areas for development.

Maintenance of records

- Records will be maintained and stored in accordance with National Regulations (177–184) and relevant agency requirements (ATO, FAO).
- Sufficient records will be kept to ensure lawful, reliable operations while protecting privacy and confidentiality.
- Induction and orientation processes will include recordkeeping responsibilities for managers, educators, and families.

Managing conflicts of interest

- All actual, potential, or perceived conflicts of interest must be declared immediately to the Approved Provider.
- Members with a conflict must abstain from discussion and decision-making on the relevant matter.
- Meeting minutes will document all declared conflicts and actions taken to manage them.

In-Service & Staff Development Policy

Professional development includes workshops, conferences, training, study, reading, and research. Ongoing professional learning enables educators to continuously improve, strengthen their skills, and identify areas for growth, ensuring the delivery of high-quality education and care.

PURPOSE

Professional development enables educators to strengthen their knowledge and skills, stay current with research, and apply best practice in education and care. As the sector evolves, ongoing learning ensures compliance with changing regulations and supports quality interactions and documentation. The Service identifies training needs through performance appraisals and regularly updates individual professional development plans to reflect each educator's strengths, interests, and goals.

IMPLEMENTATION

Educators are expected to take responsibility for reflecting on their professional values, knowledge, and practice, contributing positively to the profession. They will engage in critical reflection, ongoing learning, and research that strengthens their own and the sector's professional knowledge.

Management will ensure:

- Ensure rosters include at least one educator with current and recognised qualifications in first aid, CPR, child protection, asthma, and anaphylaxis management.
- Maintain accurate records of all professional development and share relevant resources and learnings across the team.
- Provide and support access to varied professional development opportunities such as training, workshops, research, conferences, and networking.
- Collaborate with the Educational Leader to identify service-wide training needs and facilitate appropriate learning opportunities.
- Implement mentoring programs and support networks to guide and inspire educators.
- Support educators' participation in professional development by allocating time and resources.
- Ensure continuity of care for children when staff rotations occur and consider individual needs during placement changes.
- Act as positive role models and promote a culture of continuous learning and improvement.

Educators will:

- Maintain current certifications in Child Protection, first aid, CPR, asthma, and anaphylaxis management.
- Participate in at least two professional development sessions annually.
- Engage with the Educational Leader to identify and undertake relevant in-service training.
- Apply new knowledge and strategies gained from professional development within their daily practice.
- Seek mentoring and guidance when needed to support professional growth.
- Contribute to a culture of reflective practice and ongoing learning.
- Act as positive role models for colleagues, children, and families.

PAYMENT OF FEES POLICY

Outside School Hours Care is offered to the families on a fee for service basis. These fees allow us the ability to pay for wages, resources, food and associated bills. Without the regular payment of fees, we could not afford to keep the service operating, which would disadvantage the families and community.

PURPOSE

For parents to gain a clear understanding of the Service fee structure ensuring children's fees are paid on time and that there are consequences for failure to pay fees on time.

IMPLEMENTATION

The fee structure of the Service includes:

General Fees

- Fees are charged per session and vary depending on the Child Care Subsidy, type of session, and if any additional fees apply.
- Guardians are required to check if they are eligible ro receive Child Care Subsidy, as all families have different circumstances.
- Fees are charged in arrears for Before and After School Care, and for Vacation Care.
- Fees are to be paid fortnightly through either a direct debit system, EFT transfer or EFTPOS.
- Fees are payable for every day that a child is enrolled at the Service. This includes sick days and family holidays but excludes periods when the Service is closed.
- Fees are charged at full sessions only (regardless of the actual attendance hours on any day).

Payment of fees

- Fees can be set up using the Service's direct debit system to allow for automatic payments.
- Families will be issued with a fee statement on a fortnightly basis requiring payment in a fortnights time.
- A dishonour fee will apply for direct debit transactions where there are insufficient funds to cover the fees.

Financial Difficulties

- If a family is experiencing financial difficulties, a suitable payment plan may be arranged with authorisation of the approved provider.

Failure to Pay

- If a family fails to pay the required fees on time, a reminder letter will be issued in the first instance. In the second instance a fee of $25 per open outstanding account will be charged.
- After 2 consecutive billing cycles where there has been a failure to pay, the account will be suspended and the guardians will be contacted.
- If a satisfactory result is not obtained, debt collection agencies will be engaged to recover the funds, including all associated late fees and debt collector fees.
- A review of the child's enrolment will occur where families are consistently late with fee payment.

Late Fees

- Our Service is not licensed or insured to have children on the premises after hours. This is a breach in the Education and Care Regulations.
- It is unacceptable to pick children up late from the Service. A late fee will apply where children are not picked up prior to closing time. Currently, a fee of $15.00 per 15 minute block or part thereof will be incurred by the family.
- A review of the child's enrolment will occur where families are consistently late picking up their child.

Change of Fees

- Fees are subject to change at any time provided a minimum of two weeks written notice is given to all families.

Cancellation

- Parents are to provide 7 days written notice of their intention to cancel a permeant booking.
- Casual bookings may be cancelled with a minimum of 24 hours' notice of the session commencing.
- If termination from the Service is required without notification, families can lose their Child Care Subsidy, resulting in the payment of full fees to be charged.

Responsibility of Management

- The Approved Provider and administration staff are responsible for the billing of fees.
- The Nominated Supervisor and Responsible Person may be responsible for chasing of fees.
- Should families wish to discuss fees, they will need to contact our admin team on (03) 8595 3022, 0466 047 908 or admin@elysiumoshc.com.au.

PRIVACY AND CONFIDENTIALITY POLICY

The right to privacy of all children, their families, and educators and staff of the Service will be upheld and respected, whilst ensuring that all children have access to high quality education and care.

PURPOSE

We are committed to maintaining the confidentiality of all information relating to children, families, staff, and visitors. Records will be securely stored, accessed only by authorised individuals, and managed through ongoing review of our systems for storage, access, and disposal to ensure privacy and compliance.

IMPLEMENTATION

Education and Care Services must comply with the *Privacy Act 1988*, including the Notifiable Data Breaches Scheme. Any suspected data breach must be promptly assessed to determine if it could cause serious harm to an affected individual.

Our Service complies with the Australian Privacy Principles (APPs) under the *Privacy Act 1988*, which govern the collection, use, disclosure, and management of personal information. These principles ensure that all personal information is handled lawfully, transparently, and securely, with individuals given appropriate access to and control over their information. We are committed to maintaining these standards across all aspects of our operations to protect the privacy and rights of children, families, staff, and visitors.

Management will:

- Ensure compliance with the *Privacy Act 1988*, *Privacy Amendments (Enhancing Privacy Protection) Act 2012*, and Australian Privacy Principles (APPs).
- Provide staff and educators with updated information on privacy law and policy changes.
- Ensure all records and documents are securely stored and maintained in line with Education and Care Services National Regulations.
- Develop, implement, and review procedures that govern the collection, use, storage, disclosure, and disposal of personal information.
- Appoint or delegate a staff member to oversee privacy compliance and related activities.
- Ensure appropriate and permitted use of children's images, with parental consent obtained before photography or video recording.
- Maintain secure storage for all files, including locked cabinets for staff and child records.
- Treat information shared by families as confidential unless otherwise authorised.
- Ensure that only relevant staff have access to necessary personal information, protecting against unauthorised access.
- Provide all employees, students, volunteers, and families with a copy of this policy.
- Handle privacy complaints promptly, following the Service's grievance procedures.
- Support educators in maintaining confidentiality through professional conduct and training.

Educators will:

- Adhere to the Service's privacy and confidentiality policy and procedures at all times.
- Keep all personal, family, and Service information secure and confidential.
- Ensure families can only access their own child's records and documentation.
- Share only essential information about a child's health or wellbeing with relevant educators (e.g., allergies), ensuring privacy is maintained.
- Seek and record parental consent before photographing or videoing children.
- Communicate respectfully and confidentially with families, discussing individual children only for educational, care, or planning purposes.
- Treat all information shared by families as confidential unless consent for disclosure is provided.
- Store and handle all documents according to Service policy and privacy legislation.
- Maintain professionalism when discussing or managing private information, avoiding discussions with unauthorised individuals.

Record Keeping and Retention Policy

The Approved Provider and Management are responsible for overseeing and ensuring records are maintained and stored in accordance with relevant legislation contained in the National Law and National Regulations and National Quality Standard.

PURPOSE

To ensure all records and information relating to children, families, educators, and the Service are accurately maintained, securely stored, and accessed only by authorised individuals, in compliance with the *Education and Care Services National Regulations* and *Privacy Act 1988*.

IMPLEMENTATION

Record Management (Regs. 177–180)

Records must be complete, accurate, and current to support the safe and efficient operation of the Service.
This includes documentation such as enrolment forms, attendance records, incident and medication reports, staff rosters, qualifications, and compliance documentation.

Confidentiality and Access (Regs. 181–182)

All records and information must be kept confidential and only accessed by authorised persons, including parents or guardians regarding their own child. Records must not be disclosed unless required by law, the Regulatory Authority, or with written consent.

Retention and Disposal (Reg. 183)

Records must be securely retained for the minimum periods specified in the Regulations and destroyed or deleted securely when no longer required. For example:

- Child enrolment, attendance, accident, and illness records — until the child is 25 years old.
- Staff employment and qualification records — for 3 years after employment ends.

Storage and Security (Reg. 184)

Records may be stored physically or electronically, provided they are protected from loss, unauthorised access, alteration, or misuse. Digital systems must be password protected and regularly backed up to maintain data integrity and confidentiality.

Management will:

- Ensure all records are created, maintained, and retained in accordance with Regs. 177–184 and the *Privacy Act 1988*.
- Maintain secure and accessible systems for record storage (physical and digital).
- Restrict access to authorised personnel only.
- Review record-keeping procedures regularly to ensure compliance.
- Provide guidance and training to educators on documentation and confidentiality.
- Investigate and report any breaches of record security or privacy in line with Service procedures.

Educators will:

- Complete all required records accurately and promptly.
- Store and handle records securely, protecting privacy at all times.
- Share information only with authorised persons or as directed by management.
- Follow Service procedures for the retention and disposal of records.
- Report any errors, missing information, or concerns to management immediately.

SOCIAL MEDIA POLICY

We recognise that social media offers valuable opportunities for communication but also presents challenges in an education and care setting. This policy outlines clear standards for employees, families, volunteers, and students when using social media for official, professional, or personal purposes.

PURPOSE

Being part of our Service carries a responsibility to uphold trust and professionalism. All social media use must reflect our Service's philosophy, policies, and code of conduct, ensuring the privacy and integrity of children, families, and educators are never compromised.

IMPLEMENTATION

Social media refers to digital platforms that enable users to create and share information, ideas, and content within online communities.

Our Service recognises the benefits of using social media to enhance communication and community engagement but emphasises the need for careful and responsible use to protect children, families, and staff.

This policy applies to all forms of social media, including (but not limited to):

- Social networking (e.g. Facebook, LinkedIn, X)
- Image and video sharing (e.g. Instagram, Snapchat, YouTube)
- Community blogs and discussion forums (e.g. Tumblr, Reddit, Quora)

Service use of online platforms

Our Service does not operate a public social media account. We use internal apps and a secure website, managed by the Approved Provider and Nominated Supervisor, to create an online community for current families and staff only.

Our internal platforms are used to:

1. Share updates on Service news and events.
2. Encourage family engagement and feedback.
3. Provide research-based information on child development and care.
4. Support professional learning and communication among staff.

Note: Service apps and websites are for professional communication only and must not be used for personal discussion or commentary.

Management will:

- Ensure privacy permissions for photos and written content are obtained in writing from families before posting to any Service platform.
- Maintain current privacy settings and security measures for all Service-managed social media accounts.
- Authorise and monitor staff access to Service social media and ensure passwords are kept secure.
- Provide guidance and training to staff on appropriate online conduct and privacy obligations.
- Address breaches of this policy promptly and professionally.

Educators will:

- Uphold privacy and confidentiality of children, families, colleagues, and the Service in all online activity.
- Only post authorised content approved by management and with written family consent.
- Never access personal social media accounts on Service devices or while supervising children.
- Refrain from posting any Service-related content, images, or commentary on personal accounts.
- Avoid using personal phones or cameras to capture images or videos at the Service.
- Conduct themselves professionally online, avoiding any language or actions that could damage the Service's reputation.

CONSEQUENCES FOR INAPPROPRIATE CONDUCT

Any breach of this policy will be treated as a serious matter. Inappropriate online conduct by staff may be considered misconduct if it:

- Damages or risks damaging the Service's reputation or relationships,
- Harms the trust between the employee and the Service, or
- Conflicts with the employee's professional duties and responsibilities.

Staff found to have breached this policy may face disciplinary action in accordance with the Code of Conduct Policy, which may include a formal warning, suspension, or termination of employment.

STUDENT AND VOLUNTEER POLICY

Our Service values the participation of students and volunteers. Having students and voluntary workers within the Service helps to inform the community about our program and the value of the work we do. Students and voluntary workers are welcome at the Service: However, the children's care and safety are our first priority.

PURPOSE

Our Service welcomes students and volunteers seeking to develop their skills and experience in early education. We value community partnerships and provide meaningful learning opportunities that align with the National Quality Framework. Students and volunteers will actively participate in daily routines and assist under appropriate supervision, consistent with their qualification level and role.

IMPLEMENTATION

management/nominated supervisor/ responsible person will:

- Approve and coordinate all student and volunteer placements in consultation with learning institutions.
- Appoint a qualified Educator to act as the *Student Supervisor/Mentor* for the duration of each placement.
- Conduct a Service orientation including tour, emergency procedures, and key policies.
- Ensure confidentiality agreements and Working with Children declarations are signed prior to commencement.
- Confirm insurance coverage, placement paperwork, and schedules are current.
- Inform families and staff when students or volunteers are attending and outline their role and supervision arrangements.
- Ensure students and volunteers are never left alone with children and are not counted in educator-to-child ratios.
- Provide access to policies and procedures relevant to their role.
- Address concerns or performance issues with the student's training provider if necessary.
- Terminate a placement if conduct breaches Service policies, endangers a child, or demonstrates unprofessional behaviour.

Educators will

- Supervise students and volunteers at all times and guide them in line with Service philosophy and the National Quality Framework.
- Maintain open, supportive communication and act as positive role models.
- Support students in achieving learning goals and completing practicum requirements.
- Provide constructive feedback and discuss concerns with Management promptly.
- Encourage initiative, teamwork, and professional conduct.
- Ensure confidentiality, professionalism, and child safety are upheld.

Work experience students and volunteers will

- Participate respectfully in daily routines, team discussions, and professional practice under supervision.
- Follow all Service policies and procedures, including confidentiality and child protection.
- Complete required documentation and communicate expectations from their training provider.
- Maintain professionalism, punctuality, and appropriate behaviour at all times.
- Seek guidance when unsure and report concerns to their Supervisor immediately.
- Never remove a child from direct educator supervision.

Probity checks

- All students will supply identity details to the Nominated Supervisor.
- All students will complete a Working with Children Volunteer/student declaration.
- All students will have a meeting with the Nominated Supervisor to receive information regarding the following service policies:
  a) Child protection
  b) Record Keeping and Confidentiality
  c) Complaints

Students at risk

If educators feel that the student is at risk of failing their practicum, the following steps will be taken:

1. The Supervisor will alert the Student's training institution Supervisor of any concerns regarding the student.
2. Both the Student Supervisor and the Supervisor will discuss concerns with the student.
3. The Spervisor will arrange for the student's supervisor/assessor to visit the Service and discuss concerns that have ascended.
4. The student's educational institution and Nominated Supervisor will govern the outcome of the practicum.

TERMINATION OF PRACTICUM

Termination of student's placement will occur if the student:

- Harms or is at risk of harming a child in their care.
- Is under the influence of drugs or alcohol.
- Fails to notify the Service if they will not be attending the Service.

- Does not adhere to starting times or break times.
- Is observed using repeated inappropriate behaviour at the Service.
- Does not comply with all policies and procedures addressed in the student package.
- Does not keep up to date with their work placement tasks.
- Removes any child or children from the direct supervision of an educator.

WRITING, REVIEWING & MAINTAINING POLICIES POLICY

While it is important to have policies and procedures in an education and care service, it is equally important that the policies are regularly reviewed, and amendments made to cater for changes in legislation and researched best practice, and changes to service procedures that aim to support ongoing quality improvement. Engagement in regular review of policies and procedures ensure that they align with quality practice within the Service and are responsive to feedback identified through the service's risk management and quality improvement systems. (Guide to National Quality Standard, 2018)

PURPOSE

To ensure compliance with the National Quality Framework, our Service will review our policies and procedures on an annual basis, or more frequently if required due to changes having occurred within the Service, or if considered best practice in respect of current research. We aim to work in collaboration with our Educators and families, gathering feedback when updating our policies and procedures to ensure that the needs of children being educated and cared for are always being met.

IMPLEMENTATION

- All policies and procedures will be accessible to families and educators at all times.
- Policies will be developed and reviewed in consultation with management, staff, and families.
- Policies will be reviewed **at least annually**, or sooner if changes occur in legislation, regulations, or Service practices.
- Families and educators are encouraged to provide feedback or suggestions for improvement at any time.
- Each policy will be **signed, dated, sourced, and referenced** upon review, reflecting current research and best practice.
- All stakeholders will be informed in writing of policy changes. Updated versions will be displayed and shared through newsletters, meetings, or digital communication.

Procedure for reviewing a policy:

1. Policies will be flagged for review through scheduled reflection, incidents, regulation changes, or feedback.
2. All stakeholders will be invited to provide input within a **two-week consultation period** (via meetings, email, or Service displays).
3. Management will collate feedback and issue a **draft policy** for final review.
4. Stakeholders will have **seven days** to provide additional feedback.
5. Once agreed upon, the revised policy will replace the existing version and be communicated to all stakeholders.

Unscheduled reviews may occur at any time to address emerging needs, incidents, or legislative changes.

In accordance with the regulations:

- Families must be notified **at least 14 days** before implementing any change that may significantly affect:
  - The provision of education and care, or
  - A family's ability to use the Service.
- If advance notice poses a risk to a child's health, safety, or wellbeing, families will be notified **as soon as practicable** after the change.
- Current policies and procedures will always be available for inspection at the Service upon request.

REVIEW HISTORY

Version	Date Modified	Details
25.1	20 October, 2025	***Additional Needs Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.* ***Educational Program Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.* ***Multi-Cultural Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.* ***Technology Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Update policy with regulation changes and new requirements around staff using digital devices.* ***Acceptance and Refusal Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Update digital storage of records.* ***Administration of First Aid*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Reduce implementation responsibilities to management and educators. Remove repeating instructions outside medication policies.* ***Administration of Medication Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.* ***Anaphylaxis Management Policy*** *– merge with asthma management policy. More concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.* ***Arrival and Departure Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Update with procedural changes based on the before and after school care environments.* ***Asthma Management Policy*** *– merge with Anaphylaxis policy. More concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.* ***Bush Fire Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy an implementation strategies. Removal of state-based specifications and content that would be better placed in a training package rather than a policy.* ***Child Protection Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of content that would be better placed in a training package rather than a policy.* ***Child Safe Environment Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of overworded definitions and tasks.* ***Control of Infectious Diseases Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Merge Responsible Person and Educator responsibilities into Educator responsibilities.* ***Death of a Child at the Service Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of support services as they will be provided to all families in the event of a death.* ***Diabetes Management Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of content that would be better placed in a training package rather than a policy.* ***Emergency Evacuation Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.* ***Excursion Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of content that would be better placed in a training package rather than a policy.* ***Health and Safety Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Split OHS and SunSmart guidance. Addition of SPF 50+ requirement.* ***Incident, Illness, Accident & Trauma Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of content that would be better placed in a training package rather than a policy. Change title to include the word injury and not accident.* ***Lockdown Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.* ***Medical Conditions Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of lengthy definitions.* ***Nutrition and Food Safety Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.*

		Photograph Policy *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Split responsibilities between Management and Educators.* ***Sleep and Rest Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Fix typo in opening statement.* ***Reportable Conduct Scheme Policy (VIC)*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of (VIC) designation in table of contents.* ***Sick Children Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Addition of family instructions. Consideration of responsibilities for Educators.* ***Supervision Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.* ***Termination of Enrolment Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Include Educator responsibilities.* ***Water Safety Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.* ***Work Health and Safety Policy*** *– merged with Health and Safety Policy.* ***Environmentally Responsible (Sustainability) Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of content that would be better placed in a training package rather than a policy.* ***Animal Pet Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.* ***Bullying, Discrimination and Harassment Policy****– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.* ***Grievance Policy (Staff)*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of content that would be better placed in a training package rather than a policy. Reduce definitions that repeat throughout the document.* ***Staffing Arrangements Policy*** *– merge with single staff policy. More concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of content that would be better placed in a training package rather than a policy.* ***Single Staff Service Policy*** *– merge with Staffing Arrangements Policy.* ***Responsible Person Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of table in definitions.* ***Behaviour Guidance Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Inclusion of Elysium's values-based behaviour guidance procedures.* ***Behaviour Guidance - Bullying Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of content that would be better placed in a training package rather than a policy. Direct actions for Management and Educators created.* ***Interactions with Children, Families and Staff Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Wording of policy reordered to flow more consistently.* ***Respect for Children Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Include Educator responsibilities.* ***Enrolment Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Include Educator responsibilities.* ***Grievance Policy (Families)*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Reorder wording to make consistent with Staff Grievance Policy.* ***Governance Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.* ***In Service and Staff Development Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of professional development examples.* ***Payment of Fees Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of CCS advice and guidance. Failure to pay clause moved to correct section. Failure to pick up a child termination clause added. General grammar changes.* ***Privacy and Confidentiality Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of overworded privacy principles.*

		Removal of content that would be better placed in a training package rather than a policy. Assign actions for management and Educators. ***Record Keeping and Retention Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Assign actions to Management and Educators.* ***Social Media Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Align policy to reflect the Child Safe Environment Policy.* ***Student and Volunteer Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies. Removal of content that would be better placed in a training package rather than a policy.* ***Writing Reviewing and Maintaining Policies Policy*** *– more concise wording of policy and implementation strategies.*

EXECUTED

POLICIES REVIEWED	October, 2025	NEXT REVIEW DATE	February, 2026
MODIFICATIONS	Policies and procedures have been reviewed and provided to all stakeholders as a draft 20/10/2025.		
VERSION CONTROL	EOSHC Centre Policies and Procedures 2025 v25.1		
EXECUTED BY	Matthew Hine (Director)		
SIGNATURE			

ANNEX A

Minimum period of exclusion from primary schools and children's services for infectious diseases cases and contacts
Public Health and Wellbeing Regulations 2019, Schedule 7

Number	Conditions	Exclusion of Cases	Exclusion of contacts
1	Chickenpox	Exclude until all blisters have dried. This is usually at least 5 days after the rash appears in unimmunised children, but may be less in previously immunised children	Any child with an immune deficiency (for example, leukaemia) or receiving chemotherapy should be excluded for their own protection. Otherwise not excluded
2	Conjunctivitis	Exclude until discharge from eyes has ceased	Not excluded
3	Cytomegalovirus (CMV) infection	Exclusion is not necessary	Not excluded
4	Diarrhoeal illness*	Exclude until there has not been vomiting or a loose bowel motion for 24 hours	Not excluded
5	Diphtheria	Exclude until medical certificate of recovery is received following at least two negative throat swabs, the first not less than 24 hours after finishing a course of antibiotics and the other 48 hours later	Exclude family/household contacts until cleared to return by the Chief Health Officer
6	Glandular fever (Epstein-Barr Virus infection)	Exclusion is not necessary	Not excluded
7	Hand, Foot and Mouth disease	Exclude until all blisters have dried	Not excluded
8	Haemophilus influenzae type b (Hib)	Exclude until 48 hours after initiation of effective therapy	Not excluded
9	Hepatitis A	Exclude until a medical certificate of recovery is received, but not before 7 days after the onset of jaundice or illness	Not excluded
10	Hepatitis B	Exclusion is not necessary	Not excluded
11	Hepatitis C	Exclusion is not necessary	Not excluded
12	Herpes (cold sores)	Young children unable to comply with good hygiene practices should be excluded while the lesion is weeping. Lesions to be covered by dressing, where possible	Not excluded
13	Human immuno-deficiency virus infection (HIV)	Exclusion is not necessary	Not excluded
14	Impetigo	Exclude until appropriate treatment has commenced. Sores on exposed surfaces must be covered with a watertight dressing	Not excluded
15	Influenza and influenza like illnesses	Exclude until well	Not excluded unless considered necessary by the Chief Health Officer
16	Leprosy	Exclude until approval to return has been given by the Chief Health Officer	Not excluded
17	Measles	Exclude for at least 4 days after onset of rash	Immunised contacts not excluded. Unimmunised contacts should be excluded until 14 days after the first day of appearance of rash in the last case. If unimmunised contacts are vaccinated within 72 hours of exposure with any infectious case, or received Normal Human Immunoglobulin (NHIG) within 144 hours of exposure of any infectious case, they may return to the facility
18	Meningitis (bacterial —other than meningococcal meningitis)	Exclude until well	Not excluded
19	Meningococcal infection	Exclude until adequate carrier eradication therapy has been completed	Not excluded if receiving carrier eradication therapy
20	Mumps	Exclude for 5 days or until swelling goes down (whichever is sooner)	Not excluded
21	Molluscum contagiosum	Exclusion is not necessary	Not excluded
22	Pertussis (Whooping cough)	Exclude the child for 21 days after the onset of cough or until they have completed 5 days of a course of antibiotic treatment	Contacts aged less than 7 years in the same room as the case who have not received three effective doses of pertussis vaccine should be excluded for 14 days after the last exposure to the infectious case, or until they have taken 5 days of a course of effective antibiotic treatment
23	Poliovirus infection	Exclude for at least 14 days from onset. Re-admit after receiving medical certificate of recovery	Not excluded
24	Ringworm, scabies, pediculosis (head lice)	Exclude until the day after appropriate treatment has commenced	Not excluded
25	Rubella (German measles)	Exclude until fully recovered or for at least four days after the onset of rash	Not excluded
26	Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome (SARS)	Exclude until medical certificate of recovery is produced	Not excluded unless considered necessary by the Chief Health Officer
27	Shiga toxin or Verotoxin producing	Exclude if required by the Chief Health Officer and only for the period specified by the Chief Health Officer	Not excluded

	Escherichia coli (STEC or VTEC)		
28	Streptococcal infection (including scarlet fever)	Exclude until the child has received antibiotic treatment for at least 24 hours and the child feels well	Not excluded
29	Tuberculosis (excluding latent tuberculosis)	Exclude until receipt of a medical certificate from the treating physician stating that the child is not considered to be infectious	Not excluded
30	Typhoid fever (including paratyphoid fever)	Exclude until approval to return has been given by the Chief Health Officer	Not excluded unless considered necessary by the Chief Health Officer

Regulation 111

A person in charge of a primary school, education and care service premises or children's services centre must not allow a child to attend the primary school, education and care service premises or children's services centre for the period or in the circumstances:

* specified in column 3 of the Table in Schedule 7 if the person in charge has been informed that the child is infected with an infectious disease listed in column 2 of that Table; or

* specified in column 4 of the Table in Schedule 7 if the person in charge has been informed that the child has been in contact with a person who is infected with an infectious disease listed in column 2 of that Table.

*Diarrhoeal illness includes instances where certain pathogens are identified including Amebiasis (*Entamoeba histolytica*), Campylobacter spp., Salmonella spp., Shigella spp. and intestinal worms, but is not limited to infection with these pathogens.

3.1 FURTHER INFORMATION

Please contact the Communicable Disease Prevention and Control Section on 1300 651 160 or visit www2.health.vic.gov.au/public-health/infectious-diseases/school-exclusion

[1] Children's services cover the terms 'education and care service premises' or 'children's services centre' used in the regulations. It includes centres such as childcare centres and kindergartens.

ANNEX B

The Child Safe Standards

Child Safe Standard 1 - Relevant entities establish a culturally safe environment in which the diverse and unique identities and experiences of Aboriginal children and young people are respected and valued.

Child Safe Standard 2 - Child safety and wellbeing is embedded in organisational leadership, governance and culture.

Child Safe Standard 3 - Children and young people are empowered about their rights, participate in decisions affecting them and are taken seriously.

Child Safe Standard 4 - Families and communities are informed, and involved in promoting child safety and wellbeing.

Child Safe Standard 5 - Equity is upheld and diverse needs respected in policy and practice.

Child Safe Standard 6 - People working with children and young people are suitable and supported to reflect child safety and wellbeing values in practice.

Child Safe Standard 7 - Processes for complaints and concerns are child focused.

Child Safe Standard 8 - Staff and volunteers are equipped with the knowledge, skills and awareness to keep children and young people safe through ongoing education and training.

Child Safe Standard 9 - Physical and online environments promote safety and wellbeing while minimising the opportunity for children and young people to be harmed.

Child Safe Standard 10 - Implementation of the Child Safe Standards is regularly reviewed and improved.

Child Safe Standard 11 - Policies and procedures document how the relevant entity is safe for children and young people.

SAFE ARRIVAL OF CHILDREN POLICY

The safe arrival of children from St Josephs School to Elysium OSHC is a shared responsibility between the school, families, and the Service. Clear communication, accurate attendance information, and consistent procedures are essential to ensuring that all children transition safely from school to OSHC and are accounted for at all times.

PURPOSE

The purpose of this policy is to ensure the safe arrival of children travelling from St Josephs School to Elysium OSHC by clearly defining who holds duty of care at each stage of the transition, ensuring children are accurately accounted for upon arrival, outlining the responsibilities of families, educators, and the school, and providing clear procedures for responding when a child does not arrive as expected.

This policy aligns with the Education and Care Services National Law and Regulations and supports compliance with the National Quality Standard.

IMPLEMENTATION

Elysium OSHC is committed to maintaining children's safety and wellbeing by implementing clear arrival procedures, defined duty of care arrangements, and timely response actions when a child is not accounted for.

Management / Nominated Supervisor / Responsible Person Will:

- Ensure a current risk assessment is in place for children travelling from St Josephs School to Elysium OSHC
- Clearly define and communicate duty of care arrangements between the school and the Service
- Ensure educators are trained in safe arrival procedures and missing child response actions
- Maintain accurate attendance systems based on family bookings
- Ensure this policy and related procedures are accessible to educators and families
- Review and update procedures following any incident, near miss, or identified risk

Educators Will:

- Collect children directly from the designated pick-up area, at which point duty of care transfers from the school to Elysium OSHC
- Supervise children at all times during the transition from school to the Service
- Mark children present on the attendance record immediately upon arrival at OSHC
- Act promptly if a child expected to attend OSHC is not present at pick-up
- Follow the staged response outlined in the Arrival and Departure Risk Assessment when a child is unaccounted for
- Document all actions taken when a child does not arrive as expected

Families Will:

- Make OSHC bookings prior to the commencement of the service session
- Ensure booking information, attendance days, and pick-up times are accurate and up to date
- Notify the Service in advance if a child will be absent, collected directly from school, or not attending OSHC
- Communicate any changes to attendance or collection arrangements as soon as possible
- Understand that failure to communicate changes may result in missing child procedures being enacted